Parliament Activities Report

Annual Report 2025–2026

Students' Parliament
International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad

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1
Introduction

1.1 The Students' Parliament

The Students' Parliament is the elected body that represents the students of the International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad, to the Institute administration. It traces its origins to the early 2000s and is one of the oldest student bodies at the Institute.

Students elect the members each year by secret ballot, using the single transferable vote, with one member for every 50 students. The Speaker administers the Parliament internally, and the General Secretary is its point of contact with the Institute. The Parliament works through seven councils, namely the Academic, Research, Health, Hostel, Infrastructure, Mess, and Stall Councils. Each council has a Council Secretary and takes up the issues in its area with the relevant offices and committees of the Institute.

Members also represent students on Institute committees, among them the Gender Sensitisation Committee, the Security Committee, the Task Force on the Use of Single-Use Plastics, and the Committee on Vegetarian and Non-Vegetarian Cuisine. The Parliament raises matters with the administration in writing and at meetings, and reports on its work to the student body.

1.2 The 2025–2026 Term

Members elected for the 2025–2026 term took charge on September 19, 2025, and took the oath of office on October 31, 2025. The Parliament convened six full sessions, on October 8 and November 7, 2025, and on January 19, March 7, May 7, and September 8, 2026.

The first session established the Infrastructure Council, which brought the number of councils to seven, and formed a working group to draft a written constitution for the Parliament. The members adopted the resulting Students' Parliament Charter on August 15, 2026, as recorded in Section 2.7. The Charter takes effect from the 2026–2027 term. Elections for the 2026–2027 term were announced on August 31, 2026.

The following events account for a large part of the work recorded in this report.

- In September 2025, Aarogya, the campus health centre, recorded 72 cases of an illness similar to food poisoning in three days (Section 5.1).
- In February 2026, about 150 students received penalties for malpractice in online placement assessments without a hearing. The Institute held the penalties in abeyance, and the Disciplinary Committee held a hearing for every student who had received them (Section 2.10).
- In March and April 2026, a shortage of cooking gas reduced the menus of the messes (Section 8.10).

- In April 2026, foul-smelling water from a sump reached Bakul Nivas and three blocks of Parijat Nivas. Polls by members recorded about 270 students with symptoms of illness (Section 6.5).
- The catering contract of the Palash mess ended on May 31, 2026. A new caterer began service on August 1, 2026, and the Bakul warehouse became a temporary dining hall (Section 8.14).
- In August 2026, the Institute announced revised Teaching Assistant stipends. At the Parliament's call, no Teaching Assistant attended the Institute's orientation meeting (Section 3.13).
- In August 2026, the Institute proposed a combined limit of 6 working days for all leave. The Parliament rejected the proposal, and the revision is on hold (Section 3.18).
- From August 20, 2026, the Health Council managed an outbreak of Hand, Foot, and Mouth disease, with at least 32 confirmed cases (Section 5.15).

1.3 Scope of This Report

This report covers the work of the Parliament and its councils from September 2025 to September 2026. For each issue it records the actions taken, in date order, and the status of the issue when the report was compiled in September 2026. Some entries from September 2025 record work that the Students' Parliament (2024–2025) began and that this Parliament carried forward.

The Parliament published two reports earlier in the term. The October 2025 report covered the first working month. The Winter 2025 report covered November and December 2025 and early January 2026. This report restates the material from both, with statuses updated, so that the full term is recorded in one document. Where the minutes of a meeting are published on the Parliament website, the entry links to them.

The Speaker compiled this report with inputs from the Council Secretary of each council. The General Secretary signed off the report.

This report refers to individuals by their office rather than by name, and removes as many personally identifiable details as possible. Appendix B lists the Members of Parliament by name. Most actions recorded here are requests and recommendations made by the Parliament to the Institute. Decisions on them rest with the relevant Institute authority.

1.4 Structure of This Report

Chapters 2 to 9 record the work of the Parliament by area. Chapter 2 covers the sessions of the Parliament, the Charter, and matters that concern the Parliament as a whole. Chapters 3 to 9 cover the work of the Academic, Research, Health, Hostel, Infrastructure, Mess, and Stall Councils, in that order. Chapter 10 closes the report.

The Appendix has two parts. Appendix A lists the abbreviations used in this report, and Appendix B lists the Members of Parliament for the term.

Each issue has a numbered section. The section opens with the background to the issue. The actions taken on the issue follow in date order, with the date of each action in bold above its text. The section ends with a status label in bold and a short account of the

position when this report was compiled. Each issue that reached an outcome carries one of the four labels below. A section without a label gives the position in its text.

Resolved	The issue was addressed.
In Progress	The issue was raised with the administration, and work to address it is under way.
Unresolved	The issue was raised, but no action has been taken, and it remains open.
Closed	No further action will be taken, because the request was declined or cannot be met.

The Contents lists every chapter and section with its page number. In the electronic copy of this report, section numbers, page numbers, cross-references, and abbreviations are links. An abbreviation links to its expansion in Appendix A.

2
Parliamentary Affairs

This chapter covers the meetings and actions of the Students' Parliament as a whole.

2.1 First Parliament Session

Members elected for the 2025–2026 term took charge on September 19, 2025, and held an introductory meeting on September 20, 2025. Members took the oath of office on October 31, 2025, and could take it in a language of their choice. The oath ceremony follows the election of the council secretaries, and so takes place some weeks after the first session.

The first full session met on October 8, 2025, at 22:00. Members introduced themselves, discussed the formation of councils, and discussed current issues informally. The session considered three motions.

2.1.1 Proposal for a Gender Council

A motion to create a Gender Council was introduced and rejected. Members objected that the council's functions would overlap with those of the Institute's Gender Sensitisation Committee (GSC). The session resolved that the Parliament would instead work with the GSC on awareness and advocacy on gender issues.

2.1.2 Establishment of the Infrastructure Council

A second motion proposed an Infrastructure Council to take up issues with campus facilities that fell outside the remit of the existing councils. The session widened the proposed scope to include IT infrastructure, so that the council would act as the Parliament's point of contact with the IT Office. The motion passed unanimously.

2.1.3 Constitution Drafting Working Group

A third motion formed a Constitution Drafting Working Group to define the structure, powers, and procedures of the Students' Parliament. A Constitution Drafting Committee had existed since 2019, and the working group revived and built on its work. The motion passed unanimously. It provided that the group would work independently and would include members of the current and previous Parliaments and two representatives of the Election Commission. Members also suggested consulting former Members of Parliament, former Election Commissioners, and alumni. The group was later renamed the Charter Drafting Panel. Its work is recorded in Section 2.7.

2.2 Second Parliament Session

The second full session met on November 7, 2025. The seven councils reported on their work since the first session.

The session agreed that the Parliament would release periodic reports listing the issues it had taken up, the minutes of its meetings, and its planned work.

2.3 Third Parliament Session

The third full session met on January 19, 2026, from 21:00 to 23:00, and attendance was compulsory. Each council reported on its work since the second session, and the matters raised are recorded under the relevant council. The session also took up the Re-Cycle initiative and the placement of dustbins, which are recorded in Sections 7.7 and 7.6.

2.4 Fourth Parliament Session

The fourth full session met on March 7, 2026, at 21:00. A Faculty-Student Interaction Session, at which students raise matters directly with faculty, took place the same afternoon.

2.5 Fifth Parliament Session

The fifth full session met on May 7, 2026, at 21:00. The Hostel, Research, and Mess Councils reported, and the matters raised are recorded under the relevant council. The largest item was the closure of the Palash mess at the end of May and the arrangements that followed.

The Mess Council held an open session on dining services the same afternoon, from 15:00 to 16:00, at which the Chair of the Mess Committee answered questions. The Council later ran a survey on campus dining, recorded in Section 8.12.

2.6 Sixth Parliament Session

The sixth full session met on September 8, 2026. It discussed the furniture for the new hostel, recorded in Section 6.15. It agreed on names for the new buildings, namely Srujana for the Student Recreation and Introspective Centre (SRIC), Gulmohar for the new hostel, and Sahyadri for the new academic block. The Institute had not confirmed these names when this report was compiled. The session also discussed recent changes and promotions among Institute staff, security cameras and the related policies and procedures, matters to carry forward to the next term, and the preparation of this report.

2.7 Students' Parliament Charter

The Students' Parliament had operated without a written constitution. The working group formed at the first session drafted one over 10 months.

July 21, 2026

The draft was circulated to the student body through a form inviting comments. The form received 9 responses by its first deadline. About 50 more responses, from students and faculty, arrived before the second deadline.

August 14, 2026

The members of the Parliament voted on the draft, which had been retitled the Students' Parliament Charter. The document sets out how the Parliament operates rather than the principles it aspires to, so the Parliament chose the title Charter over Constitution. The Parliament plans to draft an honour code and further documents, which may later be combined with the Charter into a constitution. The vote passed with 25 votes in favour and none against, which exceeds the support of three-fourths of all members that the Charter requires for its adoption.

August 15, 2026

The Charter was adopted and signed after the Independence Day flag hoisting. The signatories were the Speaker, the General Secretary, the Chief Election Commissioner, the Dean (Students), and the Director.

The main provisions of the Charter are as follows.

1. **Elections.** The Election Commission is independent of the Parliament. It conducts the elections, in which students elect members by secret ballot using the single transferable vote, a ranked-choice method. The Parliament has one member for every 50 students. A constituency in which fewer than half of the students vote loses seats in proportion to its turnout. In every constituency with more than one seat, at least one-fourth of the seats are reserved for women and gender-diverse students.
2. **Term.** A term lasts until the results of the next general election are announced, and cannot exceed 400 days.
3. **Offices.** The General Secretary is the Parliament's external point of contact, and the Speaker is its internal administrator. Each council has a Council Secretary. The Charter creates no executive hierarchy, and these offices hold only the powers that the Charter grants them.
4. **Councils and panels.** The Charter sets the composition and remit of the seven councils, and allows the Parliament to form panels with specific terms of reference.
5. **Sessions.** The Speaker convenes a full session at least once every 30 days. The Parliament publishes the list of attendees and a summary within two days of each session, and members answer questions from students for at least 15 minutes after it.
6. **Duties.** Every member holds office hours at least once every 15 days. The Parliament publishes an activities report at least twice each term, and responds to written communication from a student within 7 days.
7. **Requests to the Institute.** The Parliament can request information or action from the Institute in writing, and expects a written response within 7 days.
8. **Accountability.** Students can petition the Election Commission for a vote of no confidence in the Parliament or in the members for a constituency, or for a direction to the Parliament. A petition proceeds to a meeting and a vote once one-tenth of the affected students sign it, or one-fifth where it concerns a single constituency.

9. **Amendment.** An amendment requires three-fourths of the votes cast, and cannot alter the democratic structure of the Charter.

Resolved

The Charter is published on the Students' Parliament website and takes effect from the 2026–2027 term. Elections for that term were announced on August 31, 2026, and are conducted under the Charter.

2.8 Extra-Curricular Activities Participation Policy

Leave and reimbursement for students representing the Institute at external events were decided case by case, without a written rule. The Parliament formed a drafting group to prepare a policy. Under the Charter, such a group is a panel.

March 8, 2026

The Parliament wrote to the Clubs Council requesting a joint meeting to draft the policy, covering leave and reimbursement, with the aim of finishing it by the end of the month. The Parliament proposed that the same rules apply to sports, which the Sports Council administers rather than a club, and to events run through the Placement and Engagement Cell.

March 2026

The group agreed a drafting approach. Clubs would submit a list of the events they intend to enter at the start of each semester, and the policy would set criteria for approving smaller events that arise during the semester. Club representatives who regularly apply for leave joined the discussions once an initial draft existed.

May 15, 2026

A form was circulated to all student bodies and clubs asking them to list the events they would enter. The form stated that responses were not binding, but that resources would be allocated according to the responses.

May 25, 2026

A final call for suggestions was issued, with a deadline at the end of that week.

The draft of May 15, 2026, sets out the following.

1. **Scope.** The policy covers national events at which students represent the Institute. Its leave provisions also apply to international events.
2. **Applications.** Students apply through the Student Life Office (SLO). Applications for pre-planned events are due by November 20 for the Spring semester and by June 20 for the Monsoon semester. Applications for other events are due at least 15 days before the event.
3. **Academic leave.** A student can receive up to 7 working days of leave per semester under the policy, with exceptions for events of high importance. This leave remains subject to the Institute's academic leave policy.
4. **Financial support.** The Institute covers travel, registration fees, and accommodation arranged by the organisers up to Rs. 1,000 per day. Travel is capped at Rs. 3,000

per student within Telangana and Rs. 7,000 per student for other states. Train travel is covered up to 3AC for journeys under 12 hours and up to 2AC for longer journeys.

5. **Reporting and penalties.** Students submit a preparation update, a post-event report, and a financial report. A student or student body that backs out of an approved event without a valid reason, or misses a reporting deadline, receives reduced support for the next event it enters.
6. **Revision.** The policy can be amended only in consultation with the Students' Parliament, and is reviewed at least once every two years. If two years pass without a review, the financial limits rise automatically in line with the Consumer Price Index.

June 2026

The Parliament asked where the policy should be submitted. It received no reply, and sent the policy to the Deans, the Director, and the Registrar, copying the members of the Student Life Committee.

In Progress

No decision on the policy was communicated during the term. The draft allows 7 working days of leave for events, which could not be granted within the combined 6-day limit in the revised leave policy that the Institute proposed in August 2026, recorded in Section 3.18.

2.9 Gender Sensitisation Committee

The Parliament nominated two of its members to the Institute's GSC. These members recruited volunteers and held sessions on consent and power dynamics as part of the Value Education course.

2.10 Disciplinary Cases on Malpractice in Online Assessments

February 17, 2026

The SLO e-mailed about 150 students, stating that the Disciplinary Committee (DC) had found them guilty of malpractice in the online assessments held for placements in December 2025, and setting out their penalties. In one case the penalties were suspension from the hostel for the Spring and Summer 2026 semesters, a compulsory three-month full-time social internship at a non-governmental organisation, compulsory completion of a course on human values and professional ethics, and removal from positions of responsibility, including Teaching Assistantships. The mails went out a week before the mid-semester examinations and during the lab examinations. The SLO sent them in bulk, rather than the Dean or the Registrar sending them individually as is the usual practice, and copied the students' parents.

Students objected that the Committee had decided without hearing them, that the evidence against them had not been shared, that the mail set out no clear route of appeal, and that student representatives had not been part of the process. The Parliament recorded that penalties awarded without evidence or a hearing violate a student's right to due process. It asked students who believed they were not involved to reply to the mail, copying the Parliament and the Placement Cell, and to ask for the evidence, and asked students to follow the SLO's instructions in the meantime.

February 18, 2026
The Speaker and the General Secretary met the Dean (Students) and the Registrar for four hours, and heard from affected students and their parents. The Institute agreed to hold all the penalties in abeyance, because the students had no chance to represent themselves, the evidence had not been shared, and the process itself was in question.

February to June 2026
The DC was reconvened. After further meetings, in which student representatives argued the case at length, the Committee agreed to hold a hearing for every student who had received the mail and to re-examine the evidence. Representatives of the Parliament attended every hearing, and many of the students were cleared. The hearings concluded in the middle of June 2026, and the Committee sent its decision to each student it found guilty after hearing them.

In Progress
The terms of reference of the DC were rewritten, and the Parliament was still trying to obtain the new terms in September 2026. The Parliament asked the Institute to write to the students who were cleared, to tell them the outcome and to acknowledge the distress the process had caused. The Institute did not do so.

2.11 Other Business

2.11.1 Council E-mail Addresses

The Parliament renamed its committees as councils, to avoid confusion with Institute committees, and needed new e-mail addresses in a standard format to match. The Chair, Student Affairs Committee (SAC) approved the request, which was forwarded to the IT Office in September 2025. The IT Office issued each council an address made up of the council name and the students' domain.

Resolved
All seven councils received their own e-mail addresses.

2.11.2 Migration of the Parliament Server

The Students' Parliament maintains a web server that hosts its public website. On September 27, 2025, the Parliament received notice that the server would move to a new machine.

September 28, 2025
The Parliament sent the requested configuration details.

October 4, 2025
The Parliament received the address and credentials for the new machine, changed the password, and began the migration.

October 8, 2025
The migration was completed. The new machine used a temporary domain name until the old machine was decommissioned.

Resolved
The website moved to the new machine without loss of service.

2.11.3 Recommendations for the Institute Communications Team

At the request of the Chair, SAC, the Students' Parliament recommended two students on November 1, 2025, to assist the Institute Communications Team.

2.11.4 Recommendations for the Indo-EU Ambassador Network

At the request of the Dean (Students), the Students' Parliament recommended two students on June 10, 2026, to represent the Institute in the Indo-EU Ambassador Network.

2.11.5 Use of the Students and Life Mailing Lists

Students told the Parliament that the volume of e-mail on the Students list, from faculty, students, offices, and other senders, caused them to miss important messages about academics, research, the messes, and the hostels. Student bodies and clubs were already required to send event and recruitment e-mails to the separate Life list, which students can filter or leave.

January 9, 2026
The Parliament proposed to the Dean (Students) that separate lists be created for event announcements and for discussion. The proposal was not accepted.

Unresolved
After a later wave of long e-mail threads, the Institute created a Discourse instance, which is a web discussion forum, at `discourse.iiit.ac.in`, and discussion was meant to move there from the Life list. However, Discourse can be reached only from the Institute network, and most students continued to use the Life list. Discussion of the matter continues within the Parliament.

2.11.6 Notification of Office Orders

The Institute issues office orders that constitute committees and make appointments. It did not always send these orders to the Students' Parliament, including orders for committees that have student members.

In Progress
The Parliament is now sent the office orders for committees that include student members. It asked to be notified of all office orders on the formation of committees and on appointments.

2.11.7 Introduction to Student Bodies

The Students' Parliament held introductory sessions for incoming students on August 3, 2026, in two lecture halls, as part of the Institute's orientation programme.

3
Academic Affairs

The Academic Council worked on the academic awards policy, attendance and leave, course withdrawal rules, examination scheduling, and the terms of engagement for Teaching Assistants.

3.1 Dean's List and Pass/Fail Course Policies

In September 2025, a student with a high Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA) was ruled ineligible for the Dean's List, although the student had not failed any course in that semester. The reason given was that the student had failed a Pass/Fail sports course in an earlier semester. Under the policy then in force, a failed course in the current semester did not remove eligibility, but a failed course in the same semester (Spring/Monsoon) from the previous academic year did remove eligibility. The same rule applied to the mandatory Sports, Arts, and Value Education courses.

September 2, 2025
The student described the case in an e-mail to the Students list.

September 3, 2025
The Students' Parliament (2024–2025) asked the Dean (Academics) for a meeting on the academic awards policy. The Dean agreed to meet the following week.

September 10 and 13, 2025
The Academic Council sent two reminders about the meeting. The Dean asked for a few more days before the meeting.

September 27, 2025
The Council met the Dean (Academics) on changes to the policy for Pass/Fail courses. Sports, Arts, and Value Education courses are together called SAVE courses. Under the new policy, a student whose attendance in a SAVE course falls below 65% fails the course, even where approved leave covers the absences, and can withdraw from the course instead of failing it. Workshops require 100% attendance, even with approved leave. The minutes of the meeting set out the full policy.

The Parliament did not oppose these attendance rules. SAVE courses have no examinations and are assessed on participation, so a student who does not attend has not met the requirement of the course. Workshops run for only two days in a semester, so missing one day means missing half of the workshop.

October 15, 2025
The Council met a member of the faculty committee drafting the new academic awards policy. The minutes of the meeting set out the proposed policy.

January 2026
The new policy for Pass/Fail courses took effect from the Spring 2026 semester. The minutes above and an Intranet document set out the full policy.

February 2026
The Council sent written feedback on the draft Dean's List policy to the faculty member leading the drafting, and requested four changes.

1. A minimum of 12 credits for students who do not have a prescribed credit load.
2. Withdrawal from a course should not remove Dean's List eligibility, since withdrawal already carries an academic consequence.
3. Where a student has an incomplete grade, the award should be held until the grade is updated.
4. The disciplinary criteria for eligibility should cover only the academic year or semester of the award, rather than the student's entire record.

Resolved
The change to the Pass/Fail policy is complete. The Institute accepted the Council's suggestions, and the revised academic awards policy will be applied for the next award list. The Institute declined to reconsider the case that started the issue.

3.2 Course Withdrawal Deadlines

The new Pass/Fail policy did not state the withdrawal deadline for SAVE courses. The Academic Council asked for clarification and confirmed the deadlines with the Dean (Academics) in February 2026.

1. For Sports and Value Education courses, the withdrawal deadline is the same as for full-semester courses.
2. Arts courses are half-semester, so students can withdraw after Quiz 1, or after Quiz 2, depending on which half they take the course in.
3. A student who withdraws from an Arts course in the first half cannot take the course in the second half, and must register for it again the following year.

Resolved
The deadlines were confirmed and communicated to students.

3.3 Course Feedback Participation

Few students fill in the mid-semester course feedback forms, which the Institute uses to improve courses and teaching. The Dean (Academics) raised the issue, and noted that students could have raised many of the concerns from the Faculty-Student Interaction Session through the feedback forms.

September 29, 2025
The Academic Office reminded students about the mid-semester feedback forms, with a deadline of October 3, 2025, and the Dean (Academics) asked the Students' Parliament to send further reminders. The Parliament sent a reminder to all students, encouraging

them to fill in the forms and stating that the feedback is anonymous and is considered by the Institute.

October 10, 2025
The Academic Office shared participation statistics with the Parliament. In Monsoon 2025, of 98 full-semester courses, 2 had a participation rate above 50% and 43 had a participation rate below 10%.

November 2025
The Council confirmed with the Academic Office that feedback responses are not linked to the student who submits them.

In Progress
Participation remains low. The Council began discussing a separate feedback mechanism for Teaching Assistants. At the start of the term the Council set the aim of having course feedback results released publicly, and the Institute did not agree to this during the term.

3.4 Feedback Form for First-Year Undergraduate Students

First-year undergraduate students reported that they had to fill in the course feedback form for the professors of all three sections, rather than only for their own. The Council raised this with the IMS team in the IT Office on October 7, 2025.

Resolved
For Spring 2026, sections were assigned through the course code, so that students fill in feedback only for the professor who teaches their section.

3.5 Normalisation of Real Analysis Marks

The Real Analysis course for first-year undergraduate students was taught in three sections, whose examinations differed in difficulty. The Council raised the issue at the meeting of September 27, 2025, and the Dean (Academics) undertook to take it up with the course instructors.

Resolved
The instructors normalised the marks for Quiz 1, and graded the course separately for each section. Other large first-year courses were also graded separately for each section.

3.6 Attendance and Leave Rules

The Institute's attendance and leave rules are as follows. SAVE courses and workshops follow the stricter rules recorded in Section 3.1.

1. The Institute requires 100% attendance. A student who misses up to 15% of the classes in a course receives no penalty in that course.
2. A student whose attendance in a course falls below 85% receives grade drops proportional to the number of classes they miss below 85%. A student whose attendance falls below 65% receives a grade of F.

3. A student can apply for leave for medical or family emergencies, for technical, cultural, or sports events, for conferences, and for similar reasons. Absences on days of approved leave do not count as absences.
4. Leave must cover at least 3 consecutive working days. Sundays and holidays are not working days.
5. A student can take up to 18 working days of leave in a semester.

3.7 Automated Attendance Alerts

IMS began sending automated low-attendance warnings from a no-reply address, and students asked whether the attendance policy had changed.

Resolved
The Council confirmed with the Academic Office that IMS sends the alerts automatically, and that the attendance policy had not changed.

3.8 Leave Processing Backlogs

Faculty need approved leave to be recorded before they calculate final grades. When the Institute processes medical, sports, and emergency leave requests late, students can receive attendance-based grade drops that their approved leave should have prevented.

November and December 2025
The Council asked the Dean (Academics) and the Chair, Campus Health and Medical Committee (CHMC) to clear the backlog before grades were calculated.

May 2026
The Council made a further formal request to the Dean to process pending leave requests before the grade submission deadline.

In Progress
The backlog recurs each semester, and the Council raises it before each grade submission deadline.

3.9 Notification Before Attendance-Based Grade Drops

The Council recommended that the Academic Office notify students by e-mail before applying a grade drop for an attendance shortage or a disciplinary action. The recommendation was intended to cover cases in which approved medical leave had not been recorded in IMS before grades were finalised, and cases in which grade drops were applied by mistake. Such cases had occurred before.

Closed
The Dean (Academics) and the Deputy Academic Officer declined this proposal, and pointed out that students can see their final number of absences in each course on the My Courses page in the Academics tab on IMS. From this number, a student can calculate how many grade drops, if any, were applied.

3.10 Academic Activities on Sundays

Lab sessions and makeup classes for a first-year undergraduate section were scheduled on Sundays, some of them to compensate for the Felicity holiday on February 14, 2026.

February 2026
The Council made a formal representation to the Dean and the Academic Office, requesting that makeup activities be limited to the designated free slots on Wednesdays and Saturdays and that Sundays be kept free.

Unresolved
The Institute made no commitment.

3.11 End-Semester Examination Slots

Space and slot constraints for the large multi-section Science 2 and Introduction to Human Sciences courses led the Institute to schedule some Spring 2026 end-semester examinations on Sundays, and to extend the examination period past the end date in the academic almanac. Students objected, and the Council discussed the schedule with the Academic Office.

Closed
The schedule was not changed.

3.12 Academic Probation Notifications

The Institute notifies a student placed on academic probation by e-mail. Where the notification arrives after the student has registered for courses, the registration has to be redone. In January 2026, a few students received their probation notifications in mid-January, after course registration.

Unresolved

3.13 Teaching Assistant Stipends and Workload

Teaching Assistant stipends were last revised in Monsoon 2022. The monthly stipends were Rs. 6,000 for a Quarter Teaching Assistant, Rs. 11,000 for a Half Teaching Assistant, and Rs. 16,000 for a Full Teaching Assistant.

December 22, 2025
The Council wrote to the Dean (Academics) requesting an increase in the stipends before the next semester. It noted that the stipends had not been raised since Monsoon 2022. It also noted that comparable institutions pay between Rs. 9,000 and Rs. 12,000 for the equivalent of a Quarter position, and that some revise their assistantship stipends every year, and it requested a regular mechanism for revision.

The Dean replied that the Institute's practice is to revise the stipends every four years, and that the next revision would take effect from the coming academic year. The Dean

stated that work on the amount of the increase and discussions with the relevant internal committees had not yet begun, but would be completed in time.

April 23, June 19, and July 20, 2026

The Council followed up. Each reply stated that the work was in progress, without further detail.

Late July 2026

The Dean (Academics) met the Council to present the newly decided stipends. The Council pressed for a further increase in the Quarter stipend, for four reasons.

1. The amount would stay the same for the next four years, and the value of the existing amount had already fallen.
2. Food prices had risen, and the existing Quarter stipend did not cover a month's mess bill, let alone meals outside campus or a month's mess and hostel charges together.
3. The increase of 25% was the lowest percentage increase in 12 years, compared with about 33% and about 28% at the two previous revisions.
4. In many courses, vivas, labs, tutorials, and paper checking take Teaching Assistants beyond 5 hours of work a week.

The Council asked for the reasoning of the Institute Affairs Committee (IAC) behind the figures, and for responses to its points. The Dean undertook to take the Council's objections to the IAC.

August 18, 2026

The Dean announced monthly stipends of Rs. 7,500 for a Quarter, Rs. 15,000 for a Half, and Rs. 20,000 for a Full Teaching Assistant, without returning to the Council with the IAC's reasoning or responses to its points. The Registrar's notice set the new stipends to take effect from the Monsoon 2026 semester.

August 21, 2026

The Parliament resolved, by 12 votes to none, to call on Teaching Assistants to boycott the Institute's Teaching Assistant orientation meeting the following day. The call asked assistants to gather outside the venue and not enter until the administration agreed to discuss the stipend. It stated that the Parliament would not be able to support students on the matter if they attended, since attendance would be taken as acceptance of the Institute's position.

August 22, 2026

The Parliament gathered Teaching Assistants outside the venue of the orientation meeting, and no Teaching Assistant attended it. The Parliament then submitted six demands.

1. A monthly stipend of Rs. 8,000 for a Quarter Teaching Assistant from Monsoon 2026.
2. A monthly stipend of Rs. 15,000 for a Half Teaching Assistant.
3. A monthly stipend of Rs. 22,000 for a Full Teaching Assistant.
4. An annual, transparent, formula-based revision of stipends.
5. Allocation of Teaching Assistants in proportion to the total workload of a course, rather than at a fixed ratio of one assistant per 20 students.

6. Formal contracts, in the form of reporting forms, that state the stipend and the expected weekly hours.

Late August 2026

The Council met the Chair of the Teaching Assistant Committee on the demands. The allocation of one Teaching Assistant per 20 students remains the baseline. The Chair stated that Teaching Assistant positions belong to the course instructor, and that the Chair cannot override an instructor's allocation. An instructor whose course needs more than about 5 hours a week per Quarter Teaching Assistant can request more assistants, and the Chair approves such requests as a formality. The request process is to be added to IMS. The Chair undertook to state in the e-mails sent to faculty and students that the expected workload is 5 hours a week, to ask instructors to explain the course structure and workload to prospective Teaching Assistants in advance, and to have the stipend for each position documented officially.

In September 2026 the Institute published the eligibility rules and code of conduct for Teaching Assistants on the Intranet. They state the expected engagement as 5 hours a week for a Quarter, 10 for a Half, and 20 for a Full Teaching Assistant.

September 1, 2026

The Council met members of the IAC, namely the Dean (Academics), the Dean (Students), and the former Director. Student representatives made the following points.

1. The increase of Rs. 1,500 for a Quarter Teaching Assistant was the same as at the previous revision despite four years of inflation, and was the lowest percentage increase in 12 years.
2. Rs. 8,000 was a reasonable figure.
3. Students had not been consulted at any stage of the decision, and had not been told the reasons for the figure.
4. The stipend recognises the value of the work that Teaching Assistants do, and that value does not fall as the value of money falls.
5. Revisions should follow a transparent formula or process, rather than a figure chosen without stated reasons.

The student representatives asked why Rs. 7,500 had been chosen and why Rs. 8,000 was unreasonable, whether revisions could follow a fixed method known to students, and whether revisions could take place every year rather than every four years.

The former Director stated that revisions may not follow a fixed percentage, although a fixed amount could be considered, and that the exact basis for Rs. 7,500 was not known to the former Director, although the IAC may have had its reasons. The Dean (Academics) stated that the figures had been shared with the Council in advance, that the Council's objections had been taken to the IAC, which made no change, and that a further increase could be considered in two years.

The administration's position was that the Quarter stipend is an honorarium for a learning role rather than a salary, and is not meant to support a student financially. The Half stipend, which is paid mainly to postgraduate students, is meant to cover their living expenses, so that they need not depend on their families.

Both sides agreed that the stipend is an honorarium for a teaching and learning role rather than a salary, and that it should not be linked to tuition, mess, or other fees. They agreed that Teaching Assistants must carry out their duties on time and must not misuse their position, for example by favouring or harming students, coercing students, or taking bribes, and that students and the Parliament should do more to prevent the misuse of such positions.

In Progress
The Parliament e-mailed the minutes of the discussions to students. The Institute set the Quarter and Full stipends below the amounts requested, and the Half stipend at the amount requested. It did not accept revisions by a fixed percentage, but did not rule out regular revisions by a fixed amount, and no revision schedule was agreed during the term. It agreed the measures on workload and on documenting the stipend and hours for each position. The Parliament registered its dissent that the Quarter and Full stipends were not increased as requested, and resolved to follow up on the implementation or further discussion of the demands that were accepted or remain under consideration.

3.14 Library Borrowing over the Vacation

Books could be borrowed for 14 days, so a student who borrowed a book before the vacation incurred a fine.

March 7, 2026
The Council asked the librarian to let students borrow books over the vacation without a fine for exceeding the 14-day limit.

Resolved
In May 2026 the Library updated its borrowing policy for the summer vacation. A student can hold up to two books over the break, from the general, social sciences, humanities, and fiction and non-fiction categories.

3.15 Lateral Entry Entrance Examination Clashes

Students reported that the dates of the Lateral Entry Entrance Examination clashed with end-semester examinations at their current universities. The issue was communicated to Apex, the student body that handles the induction of first-year undergraduate and post-graduate students, and Apex checked with the Admissions Office. Logistical constraints required the dates to stay fixed.

Closed
The schedule could not be changed.

3.16 Intranet Documentation

Several policy documents on the Intranet are out of date compared with policies circulated by e-mail. The Council took up updating course syllabi and policy documents. It also

proposed that instructors be required to follow the grading components stated in the syllabus they publish.

In Progress
The updates depend on a new Intranet portal that was under development at the close of the term.

3.17 Submission of Project Grades

July 27, 2026
The Academic Council met the Dean (Academics), the Dean (Students), and several programme coordinators. The Dean (Academics) proposed a new policy for the submission of project grades. The Dean's main concern was a mechanism to ensure that grades are given on time. As under the existing policy, a student who did not submit the project report by the end of the semester would receive a grade of F. Under the new part of the proposal, a student who submitted the report would also receive a grade of F if the faculty advisor did not grade it by an extended deadline. The reasoning was that the student and the advisor work as a team, so the grade applies to both, and a student who wants to avoid a failing grade should follow up with the advisor to get the report graded.

The Council opposed the proposal. It argued that faculty would have no incentive to grade on time, that students whose advisors are unresponsive or on leave would be penalised for a delay outside their control, that a grade of F cannot be reversed, and that the penalty was out of proportion to the problem.

Resolved
After a long discussion, the Dean (Academics) agreed to a different mechanism. If a grade is not given by the extended deadline, the matter goes to the head of the research centre, who is to ensure that a grade is given.

3.18 Proposed Revision of the Leave Policy

The attendance and leave rules in force are set out in Section 3.6. In mid-2026 the Institute proposed a revision of the leave policy, which arose from the Health Council's menstrual leave proposal recorded in Section 5.8. The Health Council had proposed up to 8 days of menstrual leave per semester. The Institute's first counter-proposal reduced the overall limit on leave from 18 to 12 working days and removed the 3-day minimum for each leave application.

August 13, 2026
Members of the Health Council and the Speaker met CHMC on the leave policy. The Chair, CHMC and the Dean (Students) presented the proposed policy, because the Dean (Academics) was not present. Its terms were as follows.

1. All leave, whether for conferences, medical reasons, family reasons, or extra-curricular activities, would be capped at a combined 6 working days.
2. Prolonged leave for severe illness, hospitalisation, or accident would be decided case by case, up to 18 working days in total, including any leave already taken.

3. Leave for examinations would fall outside the 6-day limit.
4. Women students could apply for menstrual leave of one or two days at a time, as an exception to the existing 3-day minimum for each leave application, but this leave would count towards the 6-day limit.
5. Leave for a medical emergency or sickness would have to be applied for within 48 hours of the student's return to classes. This rule already existed but had not been enforced, and IMS would now enforce it.

The Institute's rationale was that 15% of classes plus 6 working days of leave amounts to around three weeks of absence in a full-semester course, which it considers too much.

Two changes to the leave system in IMS were to accompany the policy. Students would see their applied, approved, and remaining leave while applying. Leave applications for technical events go to an advisor or programme coordinator, and had stalled when the approver did not know they had to act. Such applications would trigger an alert after three weeks.

At the same meeting, the Parliament rejected the policy in its proposed form and asked for the limit to be raised to at least 12 working days, for two reasons.

1. The proposal did not include the parts of the menstrual leave policy that the Parliament had requested, in particular self-approved menstrual leave. A student taking 2 days a month over 4 months would need 8 days of menstrual leave alone, more than the entire 6-day allowance.
2. A 6-day limit would make it difficult for students attending workshops, conferences, hackathons, or sports and cultural events representing the Institute to obtain full leave, since a single such event can take a week. The Parliament's draft policy on such events is recorded in Section 2.8.

The Parliament based the figure of 12 days on the attendance threshold. Twelve working days is two weeks, or about 4 classes in a course that meets twice a week, which is about 15% of the classes. Together with the 15% of classes a student may miss without penalty, a student could miss about 30% of the classes in a course, which keeps attendance above the 65% threshold for a grade of F.

August 18, 2026

The Parliament informed students of the proposal. The message stated that the policy had not been implemented, set out its terms, the Institute's rationale, and the Parliament's objections, and advised students to keep some leave in reserve so that they would be covered if the policy was introduced during the semester.

In Progress

The Institute stated that it would discuss the objections at the IAC and respond. No decision was communicated, and the revised policy had not been implemented when this report was compiled. The Parliament also requested that the existing policy not be changed in the middle of the semester, and the Institute agreed. The revised policy is on hold. Some members of CHMC also raised objections to it at the meeting, while the IAC still favours the 6-day limit. If the policy is introduced, it will take effect only from a following semester, and the Parliament will be consulted again first.

4
Research Affairs

The Research Council worked on documenting graduation requirements for research programmes, writing tools for research students, and support for students facing delays in graduation.

4.1 Discontinuation of Grammarly

Research students had access to a Grammarly subscription. Usage data showed that about 300 of the roughly 600 subscribed students were active users, and that most of them used it occasionally rather than daily. Grammarly's pricing required the Institute to pay for 1,000 subscriptions. In September 2025 the Students' Parliament (2024–2025) circulated a usage survey among research students, which confirmed that most respondents used Grammarly only occasionally. The Institute decided not to renew the subscription because of the low usage and high cost, and the Parliament did not oppose the decision.

October 1, 2025
The Council met the IT Head about the discontinuation. The IT Head offered to return to the Institute's Technical Resource Committee (TRC) if students could suggest an alternative writing tool with more flexible pricing, higher expected usage, and comparable functions.

December 2025
The Research Council recommended Harper as the alternative. Harper needs no subscription and runs offline on the user's own device.

Closed
Harper became the recommended alternative to Grammarly. The Institute bought no replacement subscription.

4.2 Overleaf Access

The Research Council also sought Overleaf access for all students. Overleaf is a browser-based editor for writing LaTeX documents together.

October 24, 2025
The Council established the existing arrangement. The Institute issues a limited number of Overleaf subscriptions to professors only. A student who needs the paid features can ask their advisor to add them to the advisor's group.

November 2025
The Council took the request for Overleaf access to the TRC. The TRC rejected it, citing the cost and the subscriptions already held by professors. The Council also examined hosting the free community edition of Overleaf on an Institute server.

Closed
The Institute bought no additional subscriptions. The self-hosted instance was not taken forward, and a future council can take it up.

4.3 Graduation Requirements for Research Students

The requirements for the Dual Degree, MS, and PhD programmes were spread across several documents. Students were repeatedly uncertain about the credit requirements and about whether a journal publication is required to graduate. At the start of the term the Council set standard documentation for these programmes as its long-term aim.

December 2025
The Council documented the credit requirements for MS and PhD students semester by semester, and asked about the official status of the journal publication requirement.

January 2026
The Council met the Postgraduate Cell (PG Cell) to discuss the documented requirements. It also proposed that the Cell support students who meet the minimum requirements within three years but whose graduation is delayed by their advisor.

July 17, 2026
The Council completed a frequently asked questions document for the Dual Degree programme.

July 18, 2026
The Council sent the document to the Academic Office, the PG Cell, and the IT Head, and asked the IT Head whether it could be hosted on the Intranet.

In Progress
The document is awaiting approval. Once approved, it is to be published on the Intranet.

4.4 Meetings with the Postgraduate Chair

A new Postgraduate Chair took office towards the end of the term.

July 23, 2026
The Council requested an introductory meeting, to present its remit and recent work and to hear the Chair's plans for the research framework.

July 24, 2026
The Council met the Postgraduate Chair and raised graduation delays, assistantship stipends, and the approval of the frequently asked questions document.

4.5 Support for Research Students Facing Graduation Delays

A group of research students in one centre reported that their thesis submission and graduation had been delayed without a clear resolution or timeline. Some of the affected students had employment that depended on completing their degree on schedule.

July 21, 2026
The Council wrote to the Dean (Research and Development), copying the Director, requesting an update on the pending resolution and the expected timeline for thesis submission.

July 2026
The Council met the affected students and supported them in raising the matter with the Dean (Research and Development) and the PG Cell.

In Progress
An Institute committee examined the matter. The Council was not informed of the committee's conclusion, and the affected students received no timeline for resolution during the term.

4.6 Duration of Doctoral Programmes

A student asked whether there should be a mechanism for concluding doctoral programmes that have run for a long period, and whether an alternative degree could be awarded in such cases.

July 2026
The existing process provides for progress reviews after the fifth or sixth year, and a stipend may be discontinued after a poor review. The Council recorded reports that these provisions are not applied consistently.

Unresolved
The Council discussed the matter internally but did not raise it with the Postgraduate Chair during the term. It remains an item for a future council.

4.7 Research Fest

The Institute's Research Fest was scheduled for September 11 and 12, 2026.

August 13, 2026
The Postgraduate Chair wrote to the Research Council and the PG Cell asking them to form an organising team for the Research Fest. The Chair asked that the team include members of the previous year's team along with new volunteers, and that they first discuss the previous year's experience and ideas for more interactive sessions.

August 18, 2026
The Postgraduate Chair asked whether an organising team had been selected. The Research Secretary replied that most members of the previous team were not available, and that a new group of students had agreed to organise the fest. The Secretary invited

the Chair to a handover meeting between the previous team and the new group on August 19, 2026.

Resolved
The Research Fest Core Team was formed and organised the fest.

5
Health Affairs

The Health Council managed disease outbreaks, followed up grievances about the campus health centre and Care Hospital throughout the year, and began work on an emergency health protocol and on mental health provision.

Aarogya is the campus health centre. CHMC is the Institute body responsible for it. Care Hospital is the external hospital with which the Institute has an agreement for the treatment of students.

5.1 Monsoon 2025 Food Poisoning Outbreak

In mid-September 2025, students across several hostels fell ill. Between September 15 and 17, Aarogya recorded 72 cases with symptoms like those of food poisoning, including stomach pain, vomiting, and diarrhoea. More students fell ill but went to external hospitals or treated themselves instead of visiting Aarogya. Most affected students had drunk water from the hostel water coolers in Parijat, Bakul, Kadamba, and Palash Nivas, and had eaten at the campus messes, mainly Yuktahar and Kadamba. The illness continued through the mid-semester examination period.

September 16, 2025
Students from Old Parijat reported that the RO filtration system appeared to be producing water that caused illness. Several students e-mailed with concerns about water quality and asked for immediate action.

September 17, 2025
The Health Council wrote to CHMC, to the Chair of the Council of Wardens (COW), and to the Water Monitoring Committee (WMC). The e-mail set out the following.

1. The 72 cases recorded at Aarogya, and further unreported cases.
2. A request for the results of the water tests from early September.
3. A request that new water samples be collected and tested.
4. A request that the primary drinking water supply be switched from RO filters to bubble-top dispensers.
5. A request for an investigation into the cause and for preventive measures.

The same day, Campus Facilities and Services (CFS) replied with the following actions.

1. Water samples from all hostels, taken on September 2 and 17, and food samples from lunch and dinner at the Kadamba mess on September 15 and 16, were sent to the Environment Protection Training and Research Institute (EPTRI) for testing.
2. Bubble-top water dispensers were ordered, with delivery expected by September 18.
3. Thorough cleaning of the RO plants began.

4. Maintenance and checks of the RO plants were made more frequent.

The Council circulated a form asking when students fell ill, what symptoms they had, which messes they ate at, and which water coolers they used. By September 26 the form had received 173 responses, and 30% of them came from the third-year undergraduate batch. Respondents could report more than one symptom, mess, and cooler. Of the respondents, 145 reported stomach pain, 93 vomiting, 87 diarrhoea, and 52 fever. By mess, 130 reported eating at Kadamba, 60 at Yuktahar, and 37 at Palash. Only 35 reported ordering food from outside before falling ill. By water cooler, 65 reported drinking water from Parijat Nivas, and about 40 each from Bakul, Palash, and Kadamba Nivas and from the Vindhya water coolers.

September 18, 2025

Bubble-top dispensers were placed in Parijat, Kadamba, Bakul, and Palash Nivas as a temporary measure.

September 20, 2025

CFS shared the water test reports for the samples taken on September 2 and on September 17, after the Parijat RO unit had been cleaned. Neither showed contamination. The September 2 samples were taken before most cases occurred. The September 17 samples from the other hostels, whose systems had not been specially cleaned, were also normal.

September 23, 2025

The test reports for the Kadamba mess food samples were received, and showed nothing abnormal.

September 25, 2025

The Council met the Chair, COW, the Chair, CHMC, and the Head, CFS to discuss possible causes, the measures taken, and preventive steps.

Norovirus was raised as a possible cause. There was no clear evidence linking the illness to food or water. The most likely cause was reported to be a bacterial infection spreading through shared spaces such as hostels and common washrooms. No clinical samples were collected from affected students, which limited the investigation.

The meeting also discussed stagnant water across campus, which allows mosquitoes to breed and was worst in Palash Nivas. The Engineering Wing took this up as a priority and repaired several pipes that had caused pools of stagnant water in Palash Nivas.

The following preventive measures were put in place.

1. The two-stage chlorination of all water, by the municipal supplier and in the overhead tanks, was confirmed as standard practice.
2. Hostel cleaning, particularly of washrooms, was increased from September 22 to October 1.
3. The Institute provided handwash and sanitiser in all hostel washrooms, and continued to do so after cases fell.
4. Better housekeeping support, with two shifts, was planned for the hostels and academic blocks, without a timeline.
5. Students were sent messages about hygiene, disinfecting personal drinking water, and using sanitiser.

Resolved
Cases fell after the preventive measures took effect and the mid-semester examinations ended. The Engineering Wing took up the stagnant water problems as a dengue prevention measure. The source of the illness was never identified. With no new cases reported and preventive measures in place, no further action was needed.

5.2 Grievances Regarding Aarogya and Care Hospital

Students reported several issues with health services and emergency procedures on campus during 2025. The Council compiled them into a summary document and a case-by-case document, and sent both to CHMC.

1. During medical emergencies, security staff at the main gate collected excessive information, including hostel name, room number, and details of the medical issue, which delayed ambulances leaving campus.
2. Care Hospital did not accept temporary identity cards for the institutional discount. First-year undergraduate, postgraduate, and lateral entry students therefore paid full price while their permanent cards were delayed.
3. Students raised wider concerns about Aarogya, including irregular doctor timings, unprofessional behaviour, insufficient stocks of medicine, and restrictive leave rules.

September 20, 2025
A student body e-mailed the administration about the first two issues. The Health Council followed up the same day with an e-mail to the Chair, CHMC, suggesting two measures.

1. Collecting only essential details at the gate, namely the patient's roll number, the contact number of the person accompanying them, and the name or address of the hospital.
2. Asking the hospital's point of contact to accept stamped temporary identity cards until permanent cards are issued.

The Chair, CHMC replied the same day and took up the identity card issue with the hospital. The hospital then accepted stamped temporary identity cards for the institutional rate until permanent cards were issued.

October 25, 2025
The Health Council met CHMC and presented the compiled feedback, and also raised menstrual leave. The minutes are published on the Parliament website. The meeting produced a list of action points, which the Council followed up at three further meetings, on December 5, 2025, January 9, 2026, and February 2, 2026.

These meetings obtained the following changes.

1. Aarogya's medicine disbursement policy was revised, and stocks were replenished to support it.
2. A register was placed at the main gate to record doctors' entry and exit times, and doctors were instructed to keep to the published hours.
3. CHMC undertook to arrange a backup doctor when a doctor leaves early for a personal emergency.
4. Night caretakers were hired for the hostels.

5. The Health Council was given a role in drafting the next agreement with Care Hospital and in the discussions with the hospital's representatives.
6. The Institute began considering agreements with three more hospitals, so that students do not depend on one.

Doctor timings did not improve, and are recorded in Section 5.4.

CHMC also asked the Health Council to work with the Mess, Stall, and Hostel Councils to identify health and hygiene problems in those areas and raise them with the appropriate Institute committees. The hostel medical room audit recorded in Section 5.11 followed from that request.

In Progress
The temporary identity card issue and the medicine disbursement policy were resolved. Doctor timings and the agreement with Care Hospital remained open at the close of the term.

5.3 Revision of the Aarogya Medicine Disbursement Policy

Students reported receiving only part of the course of medicine prescribed at Aarogya.

December 5, 2025
The Health Council informed all students by e-mail of a revision to Aarogya's medicine disbursement policy. Aarogya now provides medicine for the full course prescribed by the doctor, for up to 5 days.

Resolved
Stocks were replenished to support the revised policy, and the Council received no further complaints.

5.4 Aarogya Doctor Timings

Doctors' adherence to their published hours at Aarogya was the longest-running item on the Council's list. A register was placed at the main gate in December 2025 to record doctors' entry and exit.

January 12, 2026
The Council raised its continuing concerns in writing and requested regular checks of the register.

April 28, 2026
Council members checked the gate register in person, and found that its entries did not match the arrival times that members observed. The Council sent photographs of the register to the Chair, CHMC.

May to August 2026
The Council checked the register several more times, most recently in August 2026, and found the same pattern. After each report, the Chair, CHMC wrote to Care Hospital asking that the doctors keep to the published hours.

In Progress
The Council proposed replacing the paper register with a digital record. Aarogya's records have moved onto IMS, where doctors and nurses record each case they treat and share it with the hostel in-charges. Using these records to manage disease outbreaks and arrange quarantine is work for the future. CHMC is also to carry out random audits, to check that cases are recorded correctly and that doctors arrive on time.

5.5 Publication of Aarogya Timings

To reduce confusion about when doctors are available, the Council published the current timings on the Students' Parliament website and in the Institute's mobile application, and updates them when they change. The timings are available on the Parliament website.

Resolved

5.6 Request for a Physiotherapist on Campus

The physiotherapist previously available on campus left the role. The Council learned in November 2025 that the physiotherapist had left permanently, rather than taking extended leave as had been assumed.

December 11, 2025
The Health Council wrote to the Chair, CHMC recommending a replacement.

Closed
The Chair, CHMC replied that the previous physiotherapist had worked on a voluntary basis, that no sanctioned position exists, and that creating one would need Institute approval. Students who would use physiotherapy services were asked to record their need through the Aarogya grievances form. Few students did so. The Council stated that it would take the matter up again with CHMC if students showed enough demand.

5.7 Memorandum of Understanding with Care Hospital

The Council reviewed the existing memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Care Hospital, valid from January 2025 to January 2027, and found several issues.

January 2026
The Council set the aim of a joint meeting between CHMC, the Health Council, and the hospital's points of contact, to agree an updated and binding document.

March 2026
The Council made the restructuring of the document a priority, using the responses to the student feedback form as its basis.

August 18, 2026
The Council received reports that the hospital was telling students that the MoU had expired, which was not the case. The Council raised this with the Chair, CHMC and with the Lead for Soft Services in CFS, who had recently joined CHMC to provide administrative

support. The hospital was moving to a new internal system, which had shown the MoU as expired. When an Aarogya doctor refers a student to Care Hospital, the doctor informs the hospital's point of contact, who issues the student a Sangam discount card. The card gives one free consultation in addition to the usual discount, provided that the student carries a valid Institute identity card.

In Progress

The MoU has several outstanding issues, and several arrangements that operate in practice but are not written down. The Council has drafted these points, which are to be formalised and included in the new MoU before its renewal in January 2027. The Council is to resend the final points agreed at the last meeting between CHMC and the Health Council, CHMC is to consider them, and the draft MoU is to be shared with the Council. The joint meeting is scheduled for October 2026. The Council's points for the MoU also include immediate treatment on presentation of an Institute identity card and medical staff who speak several languages.

5.8 Menstrual Leave Policy

The Council first raised menstrual leave with CHMC in October 2025. Under the rules in force, a student needs a prescription to obtain leave, and cannot take leave for fewer than three days.

March 7, 2026

The Speaker wrote to a member of the GSC, copying the Health Council, to ask about earlier efforts towards a menstrual leave policy and the best way to proceed.

March 2026

The Council drafted a policy and circulated a survey through the campus women's group. The survey received about 100 responses, which the Council compiled and cleaned before submission. Circulating the survey by e-mail as well would have reached more students.

Early April 2026

The Council settled its position before meeting CHMC. It requested up to 8 days of menstrual leave per semester, approved by the student without a prescription, and allocated across the semester rather than capped monthly, since cycles are irregular and two can fall in one month. The proposal left leave covering an examination to the ordinary medical leave process.

April 7, 2026

The Council met CHMC and the GSC member, and presented the policy and the survey data. CHMC forwarded this as a recommendation to the Dean following the meeting.

July and August 2026

The IAC took up the recommendation and returned it as part of a wider revision of the leave policy. That revision, recorded in Section 3.18, allows one or two days of menstrual leave without the 3-day minimum, but counts it against a combined 6-day limit for all leave, and does not let students approve their own leave.

In Progress
The Institute did not adopt a menstrual leave policy in the form the Council proposed. The Parliament rejected the wider revision. Its objections, and the status of the revision, are recorded in Section 3.18.

5.9 Mental Health Provision

At the start of the term the Council set the aim of better mental health provision on campus, in coordination with the Campus Mental Health Committee.

December 2025
The Council held preliminary internal discussions and planned meetings with the appropriate Institute bodies.

July 7, 2026
The Institute reconstituted the Counselling and Wellness Cell. The Council identified the Cell as its partner on mental health provision.

In Progress
Formal mental health facilities remained pending at the close of the term.

5.10 Health Records for New Admissions

The Council proposed that the admission process collect health information that would help during an outbreak or a medical emergency.

April 14, 2026
The Council followed up with the Registrar on the voluntary inclusion of vaccination status, blood group, and emergency medical information in the admission forms.

Resolved
Incoming first-year students in 2026 filled in a medical information form, with fields for vaccination status, blood group, allergies, mental health conditions, phobias, medications, and similar information. None of the fields was compulsory.

5.11 Hostel Medical Room Audit

April 20, 2026
The Council audited the first aid supplies and facilities of the medical rooms in Parijat, Kadamba, Palash, and Bakul Nivas. Across these hostels the audit found missing thermometers, understocked first aid kits, wheelchairs without footrests, and seasonal waterlogging.

In Progress
In June 2026 the Council began compiling the findings for all hostels, separating the items it could handle from those that need administrative action. The compilation was not complete at the close of the term.

5.12 Wheelchairs on Campus

The audit of the hostel medical rooms, recorded in Section 5.11, found wheelchairs without footrests.

In Progress
CHMC is considering wheelchair models for the campus and the hostels, and arranging their purchase. It plans to buy orthopaedic wheelchairs, since the most common injuries among students are sprains and fractures sustained during sports. The faculty and staff quarters have different needs, and a suitable model is to be chosen for them.

5.13 Emergency Medical Assistance Limit

The Institute previously insured students, and replaced the insurance with the Student Medical Reimbursement Fund, which pays up to Rs. 50,000 per person. The limit has not been revised for several years.

August 11, 2026
The Council resolved to request figures on how many students have needed more than the limit, and to use them to support a request for an annual revision.

In Progress
The Council is to revisit the wording of the policy and the limit on the amount.

5.14 Chickenpox Cases

January 26, 2026
A suspected case was reported. The student was isolated and a campus-wide advisory was issued. Aarogya's diagnosis was later found to be incorrect, and the case was not chickenpox.

April 6 to 9, 2026
The Council managed four confirmed cases across campus. It coordinated isolation rooms, arranged delivery of food from the Kadamba mess, arranged quarantine for roommates, and sent advisory e-mails to the campus lists. It prepared a contingency plan to request that classes move online if the number of cases exceeded five, which did not happen.

August 12 to 18, 2026
Four further confirmed cases of chickenpox were reported at the start of the Monsoon 2026 semester. The affected students moved to isolation rooms, their contacts were asked to isolate, and CHMC was notified of each case. With the consent of the students concerned, the Council sent advisories naming the affected blocks to the Students list, so that residents could take precautions.

Resolved
No further chickenpox cases were reported after the HFMD outbreak began.

5.15 Hand, Foot, and Mouth Disease Outbreak

Hand, Foot, and Mouth disease (HFMD) is a viral illness that causes mouth ulcers and blisters on the hands and feet, usually with fever. It is rarely severe in adults, but it spreads quickly through contact with surfaces, saliva, respiratory droplets, and blister fluid. It is serious for young children, including the children of faculty and staff who live on campus, and for people with weakened immune systems. In adults its symptoms make walking, eating, and drinking difficult.

Between August 20 and September 8, 2026, the Health Council recorded at least 32 confirmed cases, of which 19 were in Palash Nivas, 9 in Bakul Nivas, and 4 in Parijat Nivas. The first HFMD cases were not brought to the Health Council's attention in time, which delayed the response.

August 20, 2026

Three cases were confirmed in one wing of D-block in Palash Nivas. The first case had not been isolated, because the disease had not been recognised. With their consent, the Council informed the Students list of the affected students and their rooms, and asked residents of the wing to watch for symptoms. It notified the Chair, CHMC the same day and requested the isolation of confirmed cases, disinfection of rooms and of surfaces the students had touched, separate washroom arrangements, delivery of mess food to isolated students, and precautions for the guards and housekeeping staff carrying deliveries.

August 21, 2026

The Council drafted an advisory for the whole campus.

August 22, 2026

The Council sent the advisory to the students, faculty, and staff lists. It described how the disease spreads, and asked students to avoid sharing food, drinks, and clothes, to sanitise shared equipment and articles, to avoid close contact and large gatherings, to wash hands before meals and after using washrooms, to use masks and gloves where infection was suspected, and to report symptoms to the Students' Parliament or CHMC.

The Council also recommended three Institute-level measures to the Registrar, the Director, and CHMC. These were masks and gloves at Aarogya and with hostel guards, relaxed attendance requirements while cases remained high, and stricter crowd control in the messes.

August 23, 2026

The Council asked students to contact a Member of Parliament as soon as they received a confirmed diagnosis of a contagious disease, so that quarantine and delivery of mess food could be arranged.

The Mess Council wrote to Campus Dining Services (CDS) requesting three precautions in the messes. These were sanitising tables before and after every meal, mess staff wearing masks and gloves while serving food and washing utensils, and disinfecting spoons, plates, and glasses in hot water.

August 24 to 29, 2026

Classes moved online for the week. Quizzes for second-year undergraduate students and above were postponed, except in small classes, where the instructor decided whether to

hold the quiz with precautions such as distancing. The Institute replenished stocks at Aarogya. The Council advised students to visit the messes when they were less crowded, using the crowd information in the My IIIT app.

Isolation capacity became the main constraint. On August 24, Bakul Nivas had one isolation room left, and double occupancy of isolation rooms was considered. The Council asked the SLO to close the music room, and asked that the gymnasium be closed and sanitised. It found that the records kept by hostel security listed HFMD cases as chickenpox, and had them corrected.

August 26, 2026

The Hostel Council sent a separate advisory to the Students list on precautions in shared hostel spaces, asking students to carry their own sanitiser when using washrooms, water coolers, and common areas.

September 5, 2026

Cases were still being reported and managed individually. Confirmed cases continued to move to isolation rooms, rooms and floors were sanitised, and mess food was delivered to isolated students.

In Progress

No new cases were reported after September 8, 2026, and a few students were still recovering when this report was compiled. The Council kept a case list, notified CHMC of each confirmed case, and, with the consent of the student concerned, e-mailed the Students list with the name, hostel, and room of each case, so that students who had been in contact with the student or lived nearby could take precautions. In several cases Aarogya and external hospitals reached different diagnoses, and the Council raised the need for confirmatory testing with CHMC. The Council followed the draft emergency health protocol recorded in Section 5.16.

5.16 Emergency Health Protocol

The Council began drafting a protocol for managing epidemics on campus after the chickenpox cases earlier in the year.

April 20, 2026

The Council formed a drafting group of members of the Parliament, including the Health Secretary, the Hostel Secretary, and members who had helped manage earlier outbreaks.

April 21, 2026

The group agreed a structure in six stages.

1. Identifying and reporting a campus-wide medical emergency, by students or by Aarogya, and recording the report.
2. Identifying whether the illness is communicable, how it spreads, and its general symptoms.
3. Identifying how to stop the spread and which activities affected students cannot undertake, and putting the corresponding measures in place.
4. Treating affected students, including help with isolation and medical care.

5. Identifying the cause and acting against it, in parallel with the earlier stages.
6. Setting a threshold at which the emergency ends, removing the measures, and continuing to investigate the cause until it is resolved.

The protocol puts the health and recovery of students ahead of investigating the cause. The group kept it separate from the campus emergency operating procedure recorded in Section 7.11, so that neither document would be taken to cover both.

The group recorded that the Institute had earlier refused first aid training for guards, because it was not part of their role. The Institute later reversed this position.

August 25, 2026

CHMC and CFS held a basic life support training session for campus staff, including guards, given by a doctor from Care Hospital.

A working draft of the protocol set out the measures to apply during an outbreak. For events, these are postponing events, holding them without audiences, and moving talks online. For facilities, they are closing the music room, gymnasium, warehouse, football ground, and tennis and volleyball courts. For hygiene, the measure is more frequent sanitisation, particularly of common areas and washrooms. For academics, the measures are moving classes online or relaxing attendance requirements.

The draft also assigns responsibilities. The Health Council collects the name, roll number, original room number, isolation room number, and mess preference of each case, along with consent to name the case in an e-mail, and notifies CHMC and students of new cases. The Mess Council asks CDS to deliver food to the rooms of quarantined students where necessary.

In Progress

The protocol remained in draft at the close of the term, and the Health Council is to complete it. The Council followed it in managing the outbreak recorded in Section 5.15.

6
Hostel Affairs

The Hostel Council worked on hostel cleaning, laundry and drying, water quality and supply, network connectivity, hostel security, and the fittings of the new hostel under construction.

6.1 Room Cleaning and Housekeeping

Rooms were cleaned once every two weeks, and in Parijat Nivas the interval sometimes exceeded two weeks. Cleaning usually took place at weekends, without notice, when many students were asleep. Earlier attempts to increase the frequency had been refused because of a shortage of housekeeping staff.

September 26, 2025
For Palash Nivas, the in-charge undertook to have rooms cleaned on schedule and to give a day's notice. A student who misses a cleaning can request one through the guard.

October 8, 2025
The Head, CFS stated that weekly room cleaning would be possible with more staff, without giving a timeline.

October 16, 2025
The Council polled all blocks of Parijat Nivas on preferred room cleaning times. The in-charge agreed to move washroom cleaning to 9:00 and to clean alternate floors rather than all floors at once.

November 5, 2025
The Council compiled the poll results and sent them to the in-charge. The revised schedule took effect from the second week of November.

November 2025
In Palash and Kadamba Nivas, members worked with the in-charges to give advance notice of room cleaning times.

December 2025
The washroom cleaning schedule in Palash Nivas was revised with defined time slots, so that no two washrooms on the same floor are cleaned at the same time.

Resolved
Fixed cleaning schedules with advance notice are in place in Parijat, Palash, and Kadamba Nivas. Weekly room cleaning was not introduced during the term.

6.2 Washing Machines

Washing machines broke down frequently because of misuse, including washing shoes and utensils, particularly in Palash and Parijat Nivas. On September 25, 2025, one paid and one unpaid machine were out of order in Palash E-block, and D-block had no unpaid machines. In Parijat Nivas, the main block, A-block, and B-block each had only one working unpaid machine and one working paid machine, and C-block had no unpaid machine.

October 8, 2025
The Head, CFS suggested posting signs near the machines stating the maximum load, to reduce misuse.

October 16, 2025
The Hostel Council wrote to the Chair, COW, documenting the broken machines and requesting repair or replacement, especially in Parijat Nivas. After further follow-ups with the Chair, COW and the hostel manager, the Chair, COW replied that new machines would be ordered to replace the unreliable ones, because unreliable vendors had made maintenance of the existing machines unsustainable.

October 24, 2025
The Council asked for a delivery date. The Chair, COW confirmed that the supplier had been contacted, and noted high demand.

October 25, 2025
The hostel manager reported that, because of the festive season, the purchase would be completed by the following Monday and the machines would arrive 4 to 5 days later.

October 29, 2025
Five new washing machines arrived. Two machines from the men's hostels were moved to Parijat B-block and to the fourth floor of the main block.

November 1, 2025
One machine was installed in Bakul Nivas and four in Parijat Nivas, in the main block and blocks A, B, and C. Palash Nivas then had 4 new machines and 2 unpaid machines in E-block, and 6 new machines in D-block.

November 3, 2025
The Council and the Chair, COW discussed moving the extra machine in Bakul Nivas to Parijat Nivas, and the machine was later moved to Parijat A-block. They also discussed a centralised laundry service.

November 7, 2025
The Chair, COW confirmed that the Institute was moving away from unpaid washing machines. The hostel fee increase coincided with this change, and was reduced by Rs. 1,000 per semester to offset the cost of the paid machines. A paid wash costs Rs. 60 per cycle, which comes to about Rs. 1,000 per semester at one wash a week. The fee increase itself was attributed to fees not having been revised for several years.

August 23, 2026
Students reported that the paid machines were poorly maintained, with detergent trays in poor condition. The Council took the matter up with the vendor through the hostel in-charge.

In Progress
The shortage of machines was resolved. The vendor carries out maintenance of the paid machines.

6.3 Clothes Drying Facilities

Parijat and Kadamba Nivas have little open airflow, which makes drying clothes difficult on rainy days. Palash Nivas has a milder version of the problem, since its drying lines are on balconies with sun and air. Parijat Nivas in particular had too few drying lines.

November 3, 2025
The Hostel Council suggested to the Chair, COW a trial of pay-and-use dryers in Parijat or Kadamba Nivas.

November 4, 2025
The Head, CFS proposed two ways to increase drying capacity, either stands or additional lines between rooms in the corridors.

November 6, 2025
New drying lines were confirmed for Palash Nivas E-block, in place of the study area.

November 7, 2025
All batches in Parijat Nivas voted on the options. The result was 3 drying lines per floor in blocks A, B, and C, and 4 per floor in the main block. The Council sent a confirmation to the Head, CFS.

January 10, 2026
The drying lines were reported as ordered, with arrival expected by the end of January.

January 27, 2026
The Council and the hostel administration agreed the location of the dryer in Kadamba Nivas. The installation required drilling and took some time.

April 17, 2026
The dryer on the second floor of Kadamba Nivas had waited about a month for installation. The Council raised this, and was told that a drain outlet pipe of the correct size was not available, because a technician had earlier brought the wrong size.

April 23, 2026
The dryer was installed and available for use. A demonstration by the supplier was still pending.

In Progress
A pay-and-use dryer was installed in Kadamba Nivas. The drying lines in Parijat Nivas have not been installed yet. The Council's position throughout the term was that paid services such as drying must remain optional for students, particularly while on trial, and use of the dryer is optional.

6.4 Water Softeners

Hard water affects bathing and leaves salt deposits in taps and fittings. A water softener reduces the hardness of water. Softened water is intended for bathing and uses other than drinking.

October 16, 2025
The Chair, COW stated that the installation of water softeners would be discussed at the next WMC meeting.

November 2025
Softeners were approved for a trial in Palash Nivas. The Head, CFS stated that they would be installed as filters on the overhead tanks by the end of January 2026.

December 29, 2025
Following a WMC decision of December 24, 2025, the Chair, COW agreed that a softener of 10 kilolitre capacity would be installed in Parijat Nivas A-block for a 15-day trial, in place of the earlier plan for Palash Nivas. The Council requested a meeting with the Head, CFS to understand the change.

January 21, 2026
It was decided to plan softeners for all hostels rather than for one, and CFS prepared a revised proposal.

February 2026
The revised proposal was awaiting approval.

March 5, 2026
WMC agreed to include student representatives in its regular meetings on hostel water matters, and representatives from each hostel agreed to attend.

March 11, 2026
At the WMC meeting, WMC stated that each hostel had different problems with the softener plans, and put the plans on hold.

August 12, 2026
WMC informed the student representatives that two new sumps, one in Palash Nivas and one in Bakul Nivas, had been designed and approved with provision for water softeners. A sump is an underground storage tank. The Bakul sump will supply softened water to Bakul Nivas, Parijat blocks A, B, and C, and the Nilgiri building, and the Palash sump will supply Palash Nivas and the new hostel. The Bakul sump is to be built first.

August 30, 2026
Tenders for both sumps were published.

In Progress
The planned trials in Palash and Parijat Nivas did not take place, and no softener has been installed. Both new sumps include provision for softeners. No completion date has been given.

6.5 Water Quality Incident of April 2026

April 8, 2026
Students in Bakul Nivas first reported foul-smelling water. Housekeeping staff and the plumbing team checked the complaint, but could not consistently detect the smell. The water was chlorinated and monitored.

April 9, 2026
Students in Bakul Nivas continued to report the smell, and raised it in the WMC student group. Staff carried out further checks and remained uncertain.

April 10, 2026
Students in Parijat Nivas blocks B and C reported an intense smell. WMC and the Engineering Wing inspected Bakul and Parijat Nivas with student representatives, and reported no odour.

Separately, Palash Nivas had an intermittent bathroom water supply from about 01:00 because of a damaged municipal pipeline, which was repaired, and supply was restored that evening. The drinking water in the ion exchange coolers had TDS values from about 400 to over 600 parts per million. The affected water was drained and the coolers refilled, which brought the value to about 100 parts per million.

April 11, 2026
WMC members visited all hostels with student representatives and confirmed the odour in bathroom taps and overhead tanks. The investigation traced it to the sump supplying Bakul Nivas and Parijat blocks A, B, and C, which had the same odour. The borewell water did not. The Chair, WMC set cleaning of the overhead tanks and sumps as the immediate measure. The odour was also reported in the handwash and plate-washing water at the Yuktahar and Kadamba messes, and in Kadamba Nivas, which shares the water infrastructure. The messes' cooking water comes through RO systems and was not affected. The bore-water supply to the overhead tanks was disinfected and tank cleaning began. In Bakul Nivas, the bore-water supply was connected directly to the overhead tank, bypassing the affected sump. Bubble-top dispensers were arranged in the affected hostels, and a water category was added to the Institute's help portal.

April 12, 2026
An external agency cleaned the Bakul sump and the Parijat overhead tanks. Leaves, sand, and other debris in the Bakul sump were considered the likely cause of the odour. Water supply problems continued in Bakul and Parijat Nivas while the work was completed, and residents were advised to use bathrooms in other hostels in the meantime.

April 13, 2026

Normal water supply was restored to Bakul Nivas and to Parijat blocks A, B, and C.

April 14, 2026

The damaged municipal pipeline supplying Palash Nivas was replaced. Excessively hot tap water in Palash Nivas was under investigation, and the overhead RO tank was shut down pending inspection, with bubble-top dispensers as the alternative. WMC proposed continuous water quality sensors, an additional storage tank, and a standard operating procedure for future incidents.

The same day, the Speaker wrote to the Registrar and the Director about the Institute's response to the incident, copying the Head, CFS and the Chair, COW. The letter raised the following concerns.

1. Polls by Members of Parliament in their batch groups had recorded about 270 students with symptoms such as vomiting, stomach pain, and fever by April 11, and the number was rising. Several students had gone to hospital or returned home.
2. The odour was not acknowledged on April 8, 9, and 10, although students reported it repeatedly. The investigation traced the problem to the Bakul sump only on April 11. The delay was one reason that no samples of the contaminated water were collected.
3. Palash Nivas had no drinking water from about 08:00 to 12:00 on April 14, without prior notice, because the overhead RO plant was shut down and the bubble-top dispensers had no water cans.
4. No water or food samples were tested, despite requests. On April 11, the Speaker had asked the Head, CFS to test tap and drinking water from all hostels, and the Mess Council had asked CDS to test food from lunch at the Kadamba mess, where more than half of the affected students had eaten. The Mess Council received no reply. No agency could sample the Bakul sump on Sunday, April 12, and a reminder the next day to sample at least the Kadamba sump, which still smelt, was not acted on. As a result, neither the role of the water in the illness nor the cause of the odour could be established.
5. The Bakul sump was not properly covered. It lies at the edge of campus next to road widening work, and trash is dumped near the sump and the borewell. The leaves, sand, and debris found in the sump could have come from either source.

The letter asked for a reply on the unresolved points by the end of the week. It also asked that the existence and composition of WMC, and the standard operating procedures agreed after the incident, be documented on the Intranet.

The Institute replied the same night. It acknowledged that it had not detected the problem with the sump in time, had no documented procedure for water contamination or health emergencies, and had not resolved the problems promptly. It apologised to the students who fell ill and asked the Parliament to convey the apology. It stated that it was preparing a better procedure and response plan, engaging an external water consultant, and working with the municipal water authorities.

April 16, 2026

At the students' request, the Registrar constituted a two-member faculty committee to review the response to the incident.

April 24, 2026

The committee submitted its report. It met students, including Members of Parliament, and the hostel and water administration, and reconstructed the timeline of complaints and responses. Its main findings were as follows.

1. Most of the delay in the first three days arose because staff, and some students, could not detect the odour, although other students reported it repeatedly. The committee recommended that the Institute act on repeated complaints of the same kind.
2. Complaints were spread across too many channels, including hostel in-charges, several messaging groups, hostel mailing lists, and direct e-mails. The committee recommended the help ticket system as the single reporting route, with alerts to the in-charge and the warden.
3. The Institute's one main plumber was already occupied with a campus-wide water shortage. The committee recommended hiring more field staff for emergencies.
4. Water was not sent for testing on Sunday because the testing agency was closed. The committee recommended identifying agencies that can test water on any day.
5. Miscommunication between the hostel in-charge and students, and field staff answering students' questions directly during inspections, made the situation worse. The committee recommended that the warden be the next point of contact after the in-charge during such incidents, that field staff update students through the warden and in-charge, and that in-charges receive communication training.
6. The committee acknowledged the role of Members of Parliament in keeping students informed. It recommended formal meetings between student representatives and wardens during such incidents, and stated that protest was not the way to resolve them.

The committee also noted that students reported illness during the incident, with about 270 reports in a student poll and 29 cases at Aarogya on April 10. It stated that the link to the water was not confirmed, because the affected supply was bathing water. This finding did not address the handwash and plate-washing water at the Yuktahar and Kadamba messes, which came from the same supply and was also affected, as recorded under April 11.

The water from the contaminated sump, and food from the messes on the days when their washing water was affected, were not tested in time, despite reminders and follow-ups from the Parliament. The messes use this water to wash utensils and vegetables. The Bakul sump water was not tested because the testing agency was closed on Sunday, and a reminder the next day to sample at least the Kadamba sump was not acted on. The mess food samples were sent for testing late.

April 29, 2026

CFS had shared draft standard operating procedures for drinking water quality management, cooler cleaning and maintenance, and sumps and overhead tanks. The Speaker reviewed them with Members of Parliament and students who had attended the previous meeting with the administration, and sent comments to the Head, CFS and the Registrar. The Speaker asked that the answers be written into the procedures, and requested the responsibility matrix mentioned at the previous meeting, because the drafts did not assign any step to anyone. The main points were as follows.

1. Define the quality team named as responsible, the laboratories that may test samples, what counts as an approved water source, and what certification a water supplier needs.
2. State where reverse osmosis, ultraviolet, and ultrafiltration systems are appropriate, and whether filter maintenance follows the manufacturer's or the technician's recommendation.
3. State how flow rate, pressure, and residual chlorine are measured, stored, and shared, extending the existing overhead tank sensors of the Smart City Living Lab where possible, and include safe limits for chlorine and other chemicals.
4. State who performs the monthly water tests, how water stagnation is avoided, and what the internal audit covers.
5. Merge the overlapping sections on non-conformance, so that the procedures cannot conflict, and keep the current practice of a student signing the cooler cleaning record.
6. State how many complaints trigger the procedure for sumps and tanks, accept complaints through help tickets or e-mail, and include the trigger for repeated complaints that the Registrar had described.
7. Send updates to students by e-mail, keep a health log, inform the Parliament's Health Council along with CHMC, share incident reports with the Infrastructure Council, and give the Infrastructure Council access to all records.

May 1, 2026

The Head, CFS answered each point and undertook to incorporate the answers into the procedures.

1. The quality team consists of the Institute's designated safety and quality officer and the external laboratory coordination function, and is responsible for water quality standards, testing, and audits.
2. Samples go only to laboratories accredited by the National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories. Approved sources are the municipal supply and borewells that meet the Bureau of Indian Standards drinking water standard, IS 10500. Suppliers must comply with the norms of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India, and CFS keeps a register of approved vendors.
3. A deployment matrix sets out where each filtration system is used. Manufacturer recommendations are the baseline, and any deviation must be documented and approved.
4. Residual chlorine is kept between 0.2 and 0.5 milligrams per litre at the point of use, and is checked weekly and after every chlorination. Sensor data is logged digitally, and CFS is to explore integration with the Smart City Living Lab dashboard.
5. CFS coordinates basic testing every month, microbiological testing every quarter, and comprehensive testing every six months.
6. The overlapping sections become a single incident and corrective action procedure. Student sign-off on cooler cleaning is retained.
7. The procedure starts on 5 or more complaints within a short period, on 3 or more complaints with at least one health case, or on any visible contamination. A repeated complaint about the same location within 48 hours triggers escalation and inspection. Complaints are accepted through help tickets, e-mail, and student bodies.

8. Updates go out by Institute e-mail. Aarogya keeps a health incident log, and the Health Council is notified. Closure reports go to the relevant student councils, and records are kept in a central digital repository that the Infrastructure Council can access.
9. A responsibility matrix is to be issued with the revised procedures.

May 20 to July 20, 2026

On May 20, the Speaker asked the Head, CFS and the Registrar for the final procedures and a timeline for adopting them, and for the recommendations of the two-member committee to be shared with students. The Speaker also reported that the technical setup of the new help portal was complete, and asked for help in working with the hostel in-charges and wardens to define its categories and its rules for assignment and escalation. The Head, CFS undertook to reply the next day. The Parliament sent reminders on May 23, June 15, and July 20, 2026.

August 4, 2026

The Registrar sent the report of the two-member committee to the Speaker. The Registrar stated that most of its points had been addressed at meetings in May and June, and that a further review would follow the report of the external consultants.

August 12, 2026

WMC informed the student representatives that it had engaged a five-member consultancy to assess the campus water pipelines, supply, and requirements, and to make recommendations covering the period to 2050. The scope also covers landscaping and the possible restoration of the pond near the faculty quarters. The consultants' report was due by September 10, 2026.

Sensors that measure TDS were installed jointly with the Signal Processing and Communications Research Centre and the Lab for Spatial Informatics, in one cooler in each hostel and one in the administrative block. CFS receives an alert when a reading exceeds 150 parts per million. Monthly water test reports are to be published on a shared drive open to all.

September 2, 2026

The Council was told that the consultants' report had not been submitted and would need a further one to two months.

September 9, 2026

WMC informed the student representatives of further work.

1. TDS sensors were installed on all overhead tanks in the hostels and in the Vindhya, Himalaya, and Kohli Research Block buildings, among others. The sensors record live and past readings, and alert CFS staff when a reading falls outside the range of 50 to 150 parts per million.
2. Water level sensors are to be installed, so that CFS is alerted when an overhead tank is empty and water can be pumped into it manually.
3. The sewage treatment plant behind Palash Nivas is being upgraded with new diffusers and ultrafiltration. The treated water, which was not used before, is to be

used for gardening, and possibly for flushing in hostel bathrooms if water quality tests allow.

4. Bids for the Bakul sump are to be opened soon.
5. The Institute now has its own team and equipment for cleaning sumps, so that contamination can be dealt with immediately rather than after an external agency arrives.

In Progress

Water was fully restored in Bakul and Parijat Nivas by April 13, 2026. CFS did not share final versions of the water procedures or the responsibility matrix during the term. The Parliament's comments of April 29, 2026, and the answers of May 1, 2026, serve as a working record of what the procedures are to contain. The consultants' report had not been received at the close of the term. The work on water monitoring, storage, and treatment continues.

6.6 LAN Access for First-Year Undergraduate Students

First-year undergraduate students in Palash Nivas requested LAN access in their rooms. The workspaces are often full, carrying a laptop everywhere is impractical, and without Internet access in their rooms students find it difficult to study there.

October 2025

The Council raised the request with the Chair, COW, who approved it and asked the Council to write to the Chief Administrative Officer (CAO). The Registrar then rejected the request. It was suggested that the Himalaya classrooms be opened as study space instead, and this was later done, as recorded in Section 7.8.

August 26, 2026

The Council wrote again requesting LAN access for the first-year undergraduate batch because classes had moved online during the HFMD outbreak. The request was accepted, and the first-year batch received temporary LAN access.

Closed

The original request of October 2025 was declined, and the Council's work moved to mobile network coverage and to opening classrooms as study space. The access granted after the request of August 26, 2026, was temporary, for the duration of the HFMD outbreak. The incoming first-year batch will not receive LAN access.

6.7 Mobile Network Coverage in Palash Nivas

A new mobile tower behind Palash Nivas, intended to improve coverage for students without LAN, supported only 4G and did not improve speeds. Students also reported dropped calls. Most students have 5G plans, so the 4G-only tower was both inconvenient and costly for them.

September 20, 2025
A technician from the operator visited campus, and students showed the technician the coverage problems. The technician recommended setting phones to 4G-only mode and confirmed that a hardware fault had been fixed.

September 26, 2025
The Council ran speed tests throughout Palash Nivas. Results ranged from 0.004 to 43 megabits per second across rooms and corridors, and many areas could not support video calls. D-block, which houses first-year undergraduate students without LAN access, had particularly poor signal. The Council shared the results with the Chair, COW.

October 1, 2025
The Hostel Council asked for an update. The Chair, COW forwarded the request to the CAO.

October 6, 2025
The Speaker wrote to the Deputy Registrar requesting an upgrade of the tower to 5G, copying the Chair, COW and the Hostel Council. The request noted that 267 of 280 respondents to an informal poll of Palash residents had 5G-capable phones. The request was forwarded to the operator the same day, and the operator confirmed that it was seeking internal approvals.

October 16 and 22, 2025
The Council followed up. On October 22 the operator confirmed that it was processing internal approvals and would give an update by the end of October 2025.

November 1, 2025
A technician and a representative from the operator visited the hostel and were shown the signal strength and speeds. Signal had improved for some students. Complaints from users of a second operator increased over the same period.

December 19, 2025
The operator reported the tower fixed, with 5G support.

Resolved
Residents of Palash Nivas reported much better 5G connectivity on most floors. Efforts to fix the issue had gone on for at least two years.

6.8 Recurrence of Mobile Connectivity Problems

April 3, 2026
Residents of Parijat and Palash Nivas reported 5G connectivity problems over several days, with Internet access unavailable at times. The Chair, COW asked the administration to take the matter up with the operator as a priority, and the Deputy Registrar acknowledged the request.

April 6, 2026
A follow-up reported no improvement. A technician visited Palash Nivas and was scheduled to visit Parijat Nivas.

April 13 and 26, 2026
Residents reported continuing problems, and the Council requested a further inspection. On April 27, 2026, the Deputy Registrar acknowledged the request and stated that the necessary action would be taken. No findings were communicated.

August 24, 2026
The Council reported severe connectivity problems with both operators across all blocks of Parijat Nivas, and in Palash Nivas D and E blocks and the upper floors of the main block. Classes had moved online during the HFMD outbreak, which made the problem more disruptive. The Council wrote to the Chair, COW and the Head, CFS.

In Progress
No resolution was communicated during the term.

6.9 LAN Faults

November 22, 2025
The Council reported LAN faults in Kadamba Nivas and Yuktahar to the IT Office.

November 25, 2025
The IT Office fixed the faults within three days. The cause was repeated failure of the uninterruptible power supply attached to the hostel's network switch.

February 10, 2026
The Council reported that the LAN in Kadamba Nivas was again disconnecting frequently, and asked the IT Office for the cause and for the steps towards a permanent fix.

April 17, 2026
The Council followed up, noting that faults were increasing as the end-semester examinations approached.

August 2026
LAN faults recurred in the hostels, and continued to some extent into September 2026. The Council wrote to all hostel residents that the persistent LAN faults had been raised with the IT Office and the Institute authorities. It circulated a form on which residents can report individual faults and record when a fault is fixed.

In Progress
The faults in August 2026 were unrelated to the previous ones. No cause had been identified at the close of the term, and the IT Office was investigating. The Institute is also upgrading the network bandwidth across campus from 1 to 5 gigabits per second.

6.10 Palash Nivas

6.10.1 Kitchen Facilities in D-Block

D-block residents requested induction stoves and a sink like those in E-block. Residents with their own utensils had to wash them in the washrooms.

October 6, 2025
The Hostel Council discussed the request with the in-charge, who agreed to forward it on receiving a formal e-mail.

October 10, 2025
The Council e-mailed the hostel manager, copying the in-charge and the Chair, COW, requesting induction stoves, sinks, and kitchen appliances. The Chair, COW approved the request the same day.

November 20, 2025
An induction stove and a sink were installed on the ground floor of D-block.

Resolved

6.10.2 Drinking Water

The water filters on the second and third floors often did not work, so residents had to go to the ground or first floor late at night. The RO and ion exchange filters on the ground floor broke down frequently.

Early November 2025
A new water cooler was installed on the second floor of the main block, and another in the Kadamba mess. A fault in which the cooler dispensed only hot or only cold water was fixed on November 7, 2025. The new cooler measured 180 to 200 parts per million TDS, and the water tasted slightly off. The Council noted that the TDS display on the ion exchange coolers has a margin of about 50 parts per million either way, and that TDS alone does not fully measure water quality.

Late November 2025
The malfunctioning purifiers were repaired several times.

In Progress
Breakdowns recurred through the year, and the coolers were affected during the incident recorded in Section 6.5. In discussions with WMC, the Council was told that no alternative cooler offered the same annual maintenance contract, the same repair service after installation, and the same features, such as separate hot, cold, and warm taps and several built-in filtration stages.

6.10.3 Hygiene and Pests

The area behind the hostel had become a dumping ground, with smells that reached rooms and a problem with rats. Ground floor rooms had mosquitoes despite pest control. Several rooms had gaps between windows and frames that let insects in.

September 30, 2025
The in-charge undertook to collect garbage more often from behind the hostel, which had been serviced less often because of its location. A request for mosquito nets on the ground floor was forwarded to the wardens. A help ticket was raised for the gaps between windows and frames.

November 7, 2025
Waste management in Palash Nivas was raised at the second Parliament session. The Head, CFS acknowledged that the area should not have become a dumping ground, and set out a plan for a garbage disposal system.

April 7, 2026
The Council requested mesh nets or mesh doors for rooms in D and E blocks. Residents often keep doors open in summer for ventilation while coolers run, particularly in rooms facing the nearby construction. The open doors let in mosquitoes and occasionally lizards. A survey of D and E block residents recorded support from 150 of 152 responding rooms. The warden asked the in-charges to raise the request through the appropriate channel.

April 2026
Mesh nets had already been fitted on the fourth floor and in the cellar of Kadamba Nivas as a trial.

In Progress
The request for mosquito nets had been pending with the wardens for several months, and is to be taken up at the next meeting with them.

6.10.4 Washrooms

The shower stalls in D and E blocks had no showerheads, since they had been removed and not replaced. Some taps had no handles, and all bathrooms needed handwash dispensers.

September 28, 2025
Following the meeting on the food poisoning outbreak, handwash and sanitiser were installed in all hostel washrooms.

September 30, 2025
The in-charge undertook to look into the showerheads.

November 12, 2025
Missing shower taps were replaced in several washrooms after the Council gave the in-charge a list.

December 2025
New shower taps were installed.

August 7, 2026
The Council reported that several showerheads and taps in Palash and Parijat Nivas were again not working, and requested repairs. It also reported, with photographs, that the washrooms in Palash Nivas were poorly maintained, with rusted or broken pipes, fittings, and stands.

In Progress
The missing showerheads in D and E blocks were not replaced during the term, and the repairs reported in August 2026 had not been completed. Both are to be taken up at the next meeting with the wardens.

6.10.5 Hot Water Supply

January 8 to 10, 2026
Hot water was unavailable in E-block and the main block for three days. The Engineering Wing repaired the system and restored supply.

6.11 Parijat Nivas

6.11.1 Water Supply

The solar-heated water often contained black particles. The hot water supply was unreliable in the evenings, and when it worked, one to two buckets of water ran before the water turned hot. Students stored this water, which raised hygiene concerns.

October 2025
The in-charge suggested that the black particles might be mud that settles in the overhead tanks during the monsoon, particularly when the tanks are cleaned. Students were asked to photograph any recurrence, with timestamps.

November 7, 2025
Salt deposits were identified as a major cause of the discoloured water, with tank cleaning as a further possible cause. The Head, CFS undertook to have maintenance carried out every 10 days.

November 2025
Heat pumps were installed in all Parijat bathrooms. Water is first heated by the solar system, and passes through the heat pumps if it is not hot enough before it reaches the taps. The solar system had become ineffective because impurities in the bore water clog its copper pipes. Cleaning the pipes is expensive, is done once a year, and lasts less than three months. Other institutes use heat pumps for the same reason.

Resolved
The heat pumps fixed the hot water supply. Any recurrence of black particles is to be recorded with photographs.

6.11.2 Washroom Facilities and Hygiene

Newspapers were not restocked regularly in the washrooms, the washrooms needed large bins for the disposal of sanitary pads, and poor ventilation caused odours.

October 2025
Air fresheners in all washrooms were replaced monthly. Exhaust fans were to be replaced over the summer. The quality and frequency of washroom cleaning were increased.

November 4, 2025
During an inspection, the Head, CFS directed that all common washrooms in all blocks be inspected every ten days for maintenance of taps, flushes, and hand faucets, which salt deposits damage.

December 7, 2025
The ten-day inspection schedule had not been put in place.

Resolved
The ten-day inspections were later put in place. Newspapers are restocked, bins for sanitary pads were provided, and the ventilation problem was fixed.

6.11.3 Doors and Windows

Late July 2026
Doors and windows in Parijat Nivas were replaced or repaired.

Resolved

6.11.4 Seepage, Mould, and External Painting

November 4, 2025
During the inspection with the Head, CFS, several rooms in the main block were found to have seepage and mould, probably from water entering from outside. External painting and waterproofing were to be carried out during the winter vacation.

December 24, 2025
No work had started.

January 12, 2026
External painting started, running from 10:00 to 18:00.

Resolved

6.11.5 Beanbags in the Basements

February 23, 2026
The Council reported that several beanbags in the basements of blocks A, B, and C were damaged and unusable.

February 24, 2026
The Head, CFS directed staff to inspect the beanbags and assess whether to repair or replace them.

March 8, 2026
The warden followed up. A vendor inspected the beanbags and assessed that repair would cost nearly as much as replacement.

March 10, 2026
The warden took up replacement for further discussion.

In Progress
Approval from the Registrar was still pending at the close of the term.

6.11.6 Security Incident

April 4, 2026
Between 21:00 and 21:30, a male student entered A-block and B-block of Parijat Nivas. Two other male students reportedly followed him in to stop him. A guard who tried to stop them was reported to have been struck.

April 5, 2026
The Hostel Council wrote to the Chair, COW, the warden, and the in-charge, copying the residents' list. It requested a full report from the Institute, stricter security measures, and disciplinary action. It also suggested posting a male guard near the campus health centre or in front of the black gate, and providing self-defence training for the female guards. The Chair, COW forwarded the matter the same night to the Registrar, the Director, the Chair, SAC, the Head, CFS, the CAO, and the incoming Chair, COW.

Resolved
The guard was taken to hospital and cleared by doctors. CCTV footage later showed no assault. After the case concluded, the Institute communicated its details to students by e-mail, and the student publication *Ping!* published an article on it. The incident led to the Council's request for two-way locks, recorded in Section 6.12, and to a list of security measures that the Security Committee took up, recorded in Section 7.13. It also informed the Parliament's contribution to the campus emergency operating procedure, recorded in Section 7.11.

6.12 Two-Way Locks and Master Keys

Students requested two-way locks after the security incident in Parijat Nivas recorded in Section 6.11.6. The existing latches cannot be opened from outside once engaged from inside, so students leave rooms unlocked when they expect roommates to return late at night. The planned locks for the new hostel were already two-way. The Council's remaining concerns were that the hostel administration should not hold unrestricted master keys that allow rooms to be entered without the residents' knowledge, and that students should have an internal bolt or latch to stop the door being opened from outside when they need privacy.

April 6, 2026
The Council requested door locks that allow authorised access from outside while letting students secure the room from inside, such as handle locks or doorknobs that lock from inside and unlock from outside with a key. The Chair, COW acknowledged the request and forwarded it to CFS, noting that it could improve students' sense of safety.

May 28, 2026
The Hostel Council raised concerns about the proposed locks in the new hostel. It requested a bolt or latch inside each room, and written clarification that guards, in-charges, and the hostel administration would not hold keys to students' rooms after handover.

July 8, 2026
The Council was informed that the Building Works Committee (BWC) had settled the design of the lock, which can be opened and locked from both inside and outside and has a bolt on the inside. The Council repeated its request for written clarification on who would hold room keys.

July 14, 2026
The Chair, COW informed the Council that the proposal was for the warden to hold master keys for all rooms in the new hostel, citing safety.

August 30, 2026
The Chair, COW agreed that written rules on holding and using master keys could be drafted.

In Progress
The design of the lock, with a bolt on the inside, is final. The holding of master keys in the new hostel and the rules on their use are to be discussed at the next COW meeting. Two-way locks in the existing hostels remain under discussion.

6.13 Summer Heat Measures

February 26, 2026
The Council asked for confirmation of the date from which residents may use personal air coolers in their rooms. The Palash Nivas in-charge indicated March 1, 2026, subject to written confirmation. Students can buy or rent coolers, and anyone who uses one pays the Institute Rs. 600 per month towards the cost of water and electricity.

April 22, 2026
The application of heat-reflective paint to the terraces of Parijat Nivas was approved, with work to follow.

Resolved
Both measures were approved and implemented.

6.14 Hostel Allocation for 2026–2027

Rooms across the hostels are allocated each year before the incoming batch arrives. In March and April 2026 the Parliament coordinated the allocation for 2026–2027 with the Chair, COW and the hostel in-charges. The in-charges allocated rooms and roommates in coordination with the Hostel Council members of each hostel as needed, taking medical conditions and similar needs into account. The Parliament also arranged storage for students vacating their rooms over the summer.

Resolved
The allocation was completed and released.

6.15 New Hostel Furniture and Fittings

September 4, 2026

The Council visited the new hostel with the Chair, COW and a member of the BWC, and reviewed the options for beds, furniture, wardrobes, and other room items. Rooms will have two cupboards, beds, storage boxes, study tables, and chairs.

The Council prepared the following points to raise with the BWC.

1. Beds tall enough to store bags, buckets, and laundry baskets underneath.
2. Smoother edges on the tables, beds, and cupboard shelves.
3. Four shelves above the desk, with a lamp below them.
4. Cushioned chairs without armrests.
5. Mesh on the small window above the door.
6. Storage below the bed, with doors that open to the sides.
7. Two drawers directly below the desk, in place of a separate side drawer.
8. Three hooks on each side near the door.

The Council also planned to discuss further visits to the new buildings, and the choice between bunk beds, foldable beds, and L-shaped or overhanging beds. The sixth Parliament session took up these points on September 8, 2026.

In Progress

The furniture remained under discussion at the close of the term.

6.16 Miscellaneous

6.16.1 Room Checking Rules

The Hostel Rules 2025 do not cover the checking of hostel rooms. The Council obtained the rules on room checks in writing from the Chair, COW, and circulated them. Room checks follow these rules. A room check requires the permission of the warden, or of the in-charge in an emergency. The student whose room it is and a Member of Parliament are to be present, and a Member of Parliament must always be present.

6.16.2 Hostel Fee Refunds

In July 2026 members asked about the timeline for refunding hostel fees for the summer vacation. The refunds are to be adjusted against the following semester's fees, under the Hostel Fee Collection Policy.

6.16.3 Bike and Cycle Parking

In September 2026 the Council was asked to help settle a policy on bike and cycle parking near the hostels. The matter is to be discussed at the next meeting with the Chair, COW.

6.16.4 Hostel Sub-Council Funds

Under the Charter, each hostel receives a budget for small repairs and purchases, which its sub-council administers with the warden's approval. The procedures are to be discussed at the next meeting.

7
Infrastructure Affairs

The Infrastructure Council worked on campus lighting, pathways and drainage, workspaces and classrooms, waste, and campus security. Its members also visited the new buildings under construction and offered inputs on them, and the Council deployed a self-hosted messaging service for the campus community.

7.1 Streetlights

Lighting was poor on the road to the BBC canteen area, between Parijat Nivas and the basketball court, and from Kadamba Nivas to Palash Nivas along the Felicity ground.

October 6, 2025
The Council toured the problem areas with the Head, CFS and other supervisors. The electrical supervisor returned at 21:30 to assess visibility at night. Three new lights were installed on the pathway to the BBC canteen, two faulty streetlights near the Guest House were repaired, and branches blocking the lights on the road from Parijat to Palash Nivas were cut.

October 7, 2025
Overgrown bushes beside the side path to David's Canteen were cleared to make the path safer.

Resolved
The lighting on all the paths listed above was improved.

7.2 Pathways and Drainage

The main pathway to the BBC canteen area flooded during the monsoon. The roots of a banyan tree beside the path to David's Canteen had damaged the path.

October 24, 2025
The Head, CFS reported that the work was awaiting budget approval from the Registrar.

November 7, 2025
Two reasons were given for the delay, namely that budget approval was still awaited and that the monsoon season is unsuitable for the work.

January 2026
Construction had not started, and no revised timeline was given. Drainage was being planned for the slope on the pathway from Kadamba to Palash Nivas and near the black gate of Parijat Nivas. It was decided not to re-tile the path to David's Canteen, because

the roots of the banyan tree that damaged the old tiles would damage new tiles in the same way.

June 6, 2026
The Council reported that the newly built pathway to the BBC canteen area was neither sloped nor drained, and asked that this be fixed before the monsoon. The pathway was completed in late May or early June 2026, flooded soon afterwards, and was fixed later.

June 23 and July 17, 2026
Waterlogging was recorded at the Parijat black gate, the Palash circle, and the path to the canteens.

August 24, 2026
The Council raised the waterlogging with the Engineering Wing, which undertook to look into the Parijat black gate. The road at the Palash circle is to be levelled and rebuilt together with the access path to the new hostel, which will take time.

In Progress
The pathway to the BBC canteen area was fixed. Leaves and debris blocking the drain openings cause the waterlogging at the Parijat black gate. It recurs regularly, and no permanent solution was put in place during the term.

7.3 Washbasins and Water Coolers at the Canteens

The four taps near David's Canteen and one tap in the BBC area did not work. Leaves from nearby trees fall into the basins at VC and BBC and clog them, and the Council suggested a small shed over each washing area. The water cooler in the BBC area did not work and was unclean.

October 7, 2025
The Council toured these areas with the Head, CFS and the head of plumbing. Repairs were promised within two to three days, along with a shed over the sinks at VC and BBC.

October 24, 2025
The Head, CFS confirmed that the tap repairs would be completed by the end of October. The shed had not received budget approval.

In Progress
The taps were repaired. The basins still clog, and no shed was built.

7.4 Cleanliness in Labs and Academic Buildings

Labs, which serve as common spaces, were not cleaned often enough, and desks were not dusted. In the women's washrooms in the Vindhya workspaces, only two of the six stalls were clean with working flushes.

October 7, 2025
The Council toured the labs and the workspace washrooms with the Head, CFS, who undertook to have the washrooms cleaned more often and to follow up on the issues in the women's washrooms.

Resolved
Washroom cleaning in the Vindhya and Himalaya buildings was made more frequent.

7.5 Washrooms in Academic Buildings

November 2025
The washrooms on the first floor of the Himalaya building and in Vindhya were renovated.

December 2025
The Council had earlier raised that some washrooms in the Himalaya building had no sanitary pad vending machines, and the Head, CFS had stated that this would be addressed. During the renovation, the machines were also removed from the washrooms that had them. When the Council raised this, the issue was acknowledged, but no timeline for reinstallation was given.

January 2026
A damaged sink in the men's washroom next to the first classroom was fixed.

In Progress
The sanitary pad vending machines were not reinstalled during the term. From August 2026, the Health Council took the matter up with CFS.

7.6 Scrap and Dustbins

Scrap had accumulated around campus, including on the third floor of the Himalaya building and behind the canteens. Construction debris from ongoing projects was piled across campus and needed to be kept within the construction sites. Many dustbins across campus were damaged.

October 24, 2025
The Head, CFS reported that a campus-wide scrap collection had been approved but not carried out, pending an asset tagging process requested by the CAO. The damaged dustbins were acknowledged, without a timeline for repair.

January 2026
On January 10, the Council met the electrical supervisor, and the scrap around campus was photographed and marked for removal. The new dustbins had not been installed. The third Parliament session on January 19 identified further locations that need dustbins.

August 14, 2026
The Head, CFS sent the Council a dustbin catalogue for 2026–2027.

In Progress

The scrap was removed. The dustbins were not replaced during the term. The Council completed its list of the locations that need dustbins, and the next council is to send it to CFS.

7.7 Re-Cycle Initiative

The Re-Cycle initiative started in 2024. It refurbished abandoned bicycles and made them available for anyone on campus to use. Each cycle's mudguard was painted yellow-green to mark it. The cycles were parked at five points, namely the Vindhya Canteen parking, the Admin Block parking, the curve near Bakul Nivas, the two-wheeler parking near Aarogya at Kadamba Nivas, and the two-wheeler shed at Palash Nivas.

The initiative later died out, for two reasons. Students damaged cycles during use, and without a way to track them, damaged cycles were left around campus and used further, which made repairs slower and more expensive. The initiative also had a small budget and depended on a few volunteers, some of whom have since graduated.

The Council prepared a proposal to restart the initiative on a different footing. The proposal, which has not been implemented, sets out the following measures.

1. Each of the five parking spots would get a stand with racks that lock the front wheel of a cycle, and a reader that identifies the cycle from a tag attached to it. The stands would use the existing wireless network that carries the campus air and water quality sensors.
2. A cycle waiting for repair could be locked remotely, so that nobody rides it further.
3. Students would borrow a cycle through a portal that identifies them through the Institute's central authentication service. Scanning the code on the cycle would unlock it, and the portal would record who borrowed it.
4. A student could keep a cycle for up to an hour, after which the portal would remind them to return it.
5. Each stand would keep a repair kit, and a local repairer would service the cycles every two to four weeks.
6. The Infrastructure Council would own the initiative, a team of volunteers from the campus community would run it, and CFS would support it.

Unresolved

The proposal was prepared but was not taken forward during the term.

7.8 Workspaces, Reading Room, and Classrooms

The workspaces had broken air conditioning, too few chairs, broken chairs, broken sockets, and lights that did not work. Students requested air conditioning in the first classroom, which was poorly ventilated and used for afternoon classes. Some sockets in one seminar hall were broken and exposed. Because the batch size had grown, the number of workspace seats was fixed, and first-year undergraduate students had no network connection in their rooms, it was suggested that the Himalaya classrooms be opened for students to study in.

September 12, 2025
The Students' Parliament (2024–2025) e-mailed the CAO and the Head, CFS, documenting the workspace issues, and received no response.

September 29, 2025
After the matter was raised at the Faculty-Student Interaction Session, the Head, CFS contacted the Council, and arranged an inspection with the heads of the electrical and carpentry departments. The following commitments were made.

1. The air conditioning in two rooms would be fixed.
2. All sockets and plug points would be checked and fixed.
3. Flickering lights and loose wires would be fixed.
4. Most chairs with broken arms would be repaired within 15 to 20 days.
5. Broken partitions and tables would be fixed within 15 to 20 days.
6. More chairs would be ordered if needed once the existing chairs were repaired.

September 30, 2025
The air conditioning, sockets, plug points, and flickering lights were repaired. The sockets in the round tables cannot be made to work, because the tables are not fixed in place and wires cannot be run across the workspace.

October 7, 2025
New lights were fitted in the reading room and Library, which stopped the flickering.

October 14, 2025
The Council wrote to the Head, CFS and the CAO listing campus infrastructure issues, and received no response.

October 17, 2025
The Council followed up, noting that opening the Himalaya classrooms as workspaces before the end of the Diwali holidays would help students preparing for Quiz 2.

October 25, 2025
The sockets in the seminar hall were fixed.

October 29, 2025
The request for air conditioning in the first classroom was approved, with installation expected within two weeks.

October 30, 2025
All broken chairs in the workspace had been repaired or replaced. An inventory found 18 chairs missing. One possible explanation is that students moved them to the reading room or the labs, which removes seating from a workspace that already has too little.

November 1, 2025
The electrical supervisor confirmed that all defective electrical fixtures and air conditioning units had been repaired and that the broken chairs had been repaired or replaced.

November 4, 2025
The IT Office installed a new router in the Himalaya building so that more students could connect.

November 7, 2025
Ten extension cords were placed across the Himalaya ground floor classrooms as a temporary measure for their use as workspaces, three each in two rooms and two each in two others.

November 11, 2025
The Himalaya classrooms opened as workspaces.

December 2025
A standing air conditioning unit was installed in the first classroom.

January 2026
The blueroom issues raised with the electrical supervisor in November remained unresolved, including a door on the first floor that does not close properly. Missing and broken foot partitions on the workspace tables had not been repaired or replaced. The air conditioning in the labs of two research centres was repaired during the winter break. After repeated e-mails from students and the Council, the lab air conditioning was later repaired at all centres that had reported faults.

September 7, 2026
The Council requested that classrooms be reopened as reading rooms outside class hours for the Monsoon 2026 semester, as in the previous two semesters, with the Himalaya classrooms available generally and three seminar halls during examinations.

In Progress
The workspace repairs of 2025 were completed, except for the blueroom items and the foot partitions. The Council had received no reply to its request to reopen classrooms as reading rooms at the close of the term.

7.9 Self-Hosted Messaging Service

Student groups on campus, including course groups and interest groups for cricket, music, and books, run on WhatsApp, which limits a group to 1,024 members. Groups had reached that limit, and duplicate groups created as a workaround had also filled. With new undergraduate and postgraduate batches joining, any new group would consist almost entirely of new students, which defeats the purpose of a common group.

The Council proposed self-hosting a Matrix server for the campus community. Matrix is an open protocol for messaging. The Discourse forum recorded in Section 2.11.5 is reachable only from the Institute network and saw little use, so the Council asked that the Matrix server be reachable from the Internet.

June 16, 2026
The Council wrote to the Registrar, the Chair of the TRC, and the IT Head, requesting a meeting to explain the plan and its benefits and costs, and to request permission.

June 19, 2026
The Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) was added to the discussion and asked for input. The Council noted that several government and public sector bodies in Europe use Matrix, and that independent security experts regularly audit the protocol and its implementations.

June 26 and 27, 2026
The CISO requested time to evaluate the protocol. The Council explained the timing constraint. The incoming batch would arrive on July 30, course groups are normally created by July 20, and groups created on WhatsApp would be difficult to move later. A meeting took place and a test deployment ran on the Institute network.

July 21, 2026
The configuration for Internet access, backups, and user reporting was completed. The Council also deployed a bridge between the existing WhatsApp groups, such as Lost and Found and Buy, Sell, and Rent, and the corresponding groups on the new service, so that a message sent in either appears in the other. Media files are not backed up, because of cost. Voice and video calling was deferred pending testing.

August 7, 2026
The service was announced to the students, staff, and faculty lists. The announcement stated that the Parliament had created the service and would manage it initially, that the IT Office would administer it, and that server administrators can see message metadata but not the content of encrypted messages.

In Progress
The service is deployed and in use. The Institute's security assessment arrived later. It listed six issues that are intended behaviour, required by the Matrix specification. It also stated that the password login endpoint was not rate limited, and recommended disabling password login in favour of single sign-on, although the server already had password login disabled and single sign-on as its only method.

7.10 Emergency Contact Number

April 17, 2026
After several reminders and escalations from the Council, the Institute established a dedicated emergency contact number for campus security. The Council prepared an announcement.

April 20, 2026
The number was published to students, with a request that they save it for situations that need immediate intervention.

Resolved

7.11 Emergency Operating Procedure

The campus had no single written procedure setting out what security staff, other staff, and students should do in an emergency. The Institute prepared a draft covering fire, medical emergencies, unauthorised entry, electrical emergencies, abduction, and theft, and gave it to the Parliament in April 2026. The first draft had several gaps. The Parliament sent a detailed list of suggestions and discussed it with the Security Committee. The suggestions included an order of escalation for each type of emergency, defined steps for the aftermath, the assignment of each step to a role, marked fire exits and assembly points, and first aid training for guards.

May 29, 2026
The Security Committee met with student representatives present and agreed the following. More guards would be posted once contracts were renewed. Improvements to campus lighting had been surveyed and approved. The boundary wall between Parijat and Bakul Nivas would be raised. Fire plans and exits would be the first priority. Training for students, staff, and guards in using fire extinguishers and in cardiopulmonary resuscitation would be arranged. The Council asked that assembly points for fire evacuation be planned and communicated to the hostel in-charges.

In Progress
The procedure remained in draft at the close of the term, and is expected to be finalised soon. It will be published to students once finalised.

7.12 CCTV Policy

The Council's position is that there should be no cameras inside the hostels, apart from the entrances and exits. After incidents in which students damaged hostel property, including washing machines damaged by crackers set off inside them, the Council did not oppose a camera in the common area that holds the machines.

May 29, 2026
The camera plan was presented to the Security Committee with student representatives present. The Council had earlier objected to cameras inside workspaces and hostels. The following points were discussed for the policy.

1. Cameras are to be placed at entry and exit points and at security posts, and not inside workspaces or classrooms.
2. The policy prohibits profiling, the use of footage to train analytics, and facial recognition.
3. Depending on the area, viewing footage requires approval from the Chair, COW, from the relevant quarters committee, or from the Security Committee. A representative of the Students' Parliament is to be present whenever footage is viewed.

4. Caterers, vending machine operators, and stall owners should not run their own cameras without approval. The committee's survey found several such cameras, and it is to decide how to deal with them.

The camera map was shared with the Parliament for its input, and the camera positions at the entrances and in some open corridors were finalised with Members of Parliament. Signs are to inform students where they are under surveillance.

In Progress

The Security Committee was drafting the CCTV policy, and it had not been finalised at the close of the term.

7.13 Enhanced Security Measures

After the security incident in Parijat Nivas recorded in Section 6.11.6, a list of enhanced security measures was requested. The Security Committee tracked the measures in an action plan, with student representatives present at its meetings. The status of each measure at the close of the term is as follows.

Resolved

- A light, fan, table, mosquito racket, torch, and enclosed seating at the Parijat Nivas entrance security post.
- A Security Office category on the Institute's help portal.
- A guard posted 24 hours a day at the main entrance of Parijat Nivas.
- Night patrols every 30 minutes, on foot and by bike.
- Maintenance of the hostel entrance doors.
- Better lighting on the roads by Parijat Nivas A, B, and C blocks, from the main gate to Palash Nivas, from the main gate to the faculty and staff quarters, and at the football ground and the Felicity ground.
- A single emergency contact number for students, recorded in Section 7.10.
- One male and one female student representative on the Security Committee.
- Fire management and first aid workshops for guards, scheduled every six months.

In Progress

- Wider CCTV coverage across campus, and a CCTV monitoring control room.
- A visitor management system.
- A revision of the emergency operating procedure, recorded in Section 7.11. A review of the procedure every five years is to follow.

Other ideas, such as a safety app for women and emergency bells in the hostels, were discussed, but need planning before they can be settled.

Unresolved

- Walkie-talkies for security staff.
- A bike ambulance with first aid equipment.
- A separate biometric pathway for pedestrians at the main gate.
- Boundary wall fencing from the Dinesh Juice Counter to the back of Bakul Nivas.
- Self-defence workshops for guards every six months.

7.14 Site Visits to New Buildings

Members of the Parliament took part in site visits to the buildings under construction during the term, including the furniture review for the new hostel recorded in Section 6.15.

7.15 Badminton Court Flooring

The SRIC is a new building under construction that will house a cafeteria, a music room, two gymnasiums, meeting rooms, and indoor sports facilities, among other things. Its badminton court was planned with a concrete or tiled floor.

June 2026
The Council proposed wooden flooring with synthetic mats, because concrete floors cause injuries during play. The Sports Council supported the proposal. The Council recorded that wooden flooring costs more to maintain.

In Progress
The court remained planned with a concrete floor. The Registrar objected to wooden flooring because of its maintenance cost. The Council later raised the matter with the Chair of the Student Life Committee, to see whether wooden flooring could still be installed.

7.16 Gymnasium Provision

The plan for SRIC contains two gymnasiums separated by a wall, one for men and one for women. The Council discussed requesting a single shared gymnasium instead, since duplicating equipment uses space and budget that could go to indoor games or better equipment. It did not take the request forward.

Students asked for a female gymnasium trainer. A future council is to take this up with the Sports Council.

In Progress
The Council pressed for better equipment in the existing gymnasium in the basement of Parijat Nivas. Earlier requests had been refused because the space is unsupervised.

7.17 Multi-Faith Prayer Room

The only prayer space on campus is a room in Palash Nivas.

August 15, 2026
The Council discussed proposing a dedicated multi-faith prayer room away from the hostels, so that all students could use it without restrictions on entering other hostels. Rooms in the Nilgiri and Vindhya buildings were considered.

In Progress

7.18 Construction and Safety Repairs

July 7, 2026
The Council raised the issue of construction noise at night near a hostel. The Head, CFS instructed the contractor to stop work by 22:00. The Council also requested that a gap in the construction barricades, opened by wind, be closed so that debris could not blow out of the site.

August 14, 2026
The Council reported protruding nails and uneven ground on the path to Palash Nivas as a hazard. Bricks had been placed around the hazard as a warning, rather than the ground being levelled.

August 19 and 20, 2026
The nails were removed and the ground was cemented.

7.19 Tree Felling near the Hostels

July 17, 2026
Trees were cut in Palash Nivas E-block and behind Palash Nivas without notice to students. The Council wrote to the Head, CFS, the Chair of the Institute Facilities and Services Committee, and the Registrar. It had learned that the tree roots were damaging the building foundations. It noted that felling reduces green cover and shade and increases heat. It asked whether transplanting the trees, planting species whose roots would not damage foundations, or compensatory planting had been considered, requested that felling pause until such plans were final, and asked for advance notice of any future felling.

The Head, CFS replied the same day. The growth being cleared was subabul, a fast-growing tree, along the room corridors and around the water sump, and its roots had damaged the plinth protection around the hostel and the sump. The reply acknowledged that students should have been told in advance, undertook to give notice of similar work in future, and stated that the removed growth would be replaced by planting elsewhere on campus, with interested students involved.

July 23, 2026
The Council reported further felling inside Bakul Nivas and near the open gym area, again without notice, and wrote to the Head, CFS, the Registrar, and the Director. It asked why the trees were cut, what the replanting plan was, and why the earlier assurance of notice had not been kept. It also noted that a detailed plan of infrastructure changes, which the Head, CFS had undertaken to share, had not been received.

August 25, 2026
Following this correspondence, a plantation drive took place with the state Forest Department outside Palash Nivas.

7.20 Task Force on the Use of Single-Use Plastics

The Institute constituted a task force to review its policy on single-use plastics, last approved in 2019, and included members of the Students' Parliament.

February 6, 2026
The first meeting covered the background of the Task Force, a review of the 2019 policy, and the next steps. Minutes were circulated on February 10, 2026.

February 2026
CFS began a fortnightly plastic-free drive on campus, called the Swachh Campus Activity, with the housekeeping staff. It also instructed the hostel housekeeping team to separate plastic waste while cleaning student rooms and common areas.

March 2026
A member of the Task Force reported that VC was still using plastic-coated plates. CFS instructed the vendor to stop using them. The vendor stated that it had old stock of the plates and that its biodegradable plates had run out. The Task Force also asked CFS to engage a professional recycler for the campus's recyclable dry waste, and to work on separating waste at source and on the size and distribution of bins across campus.

April 26, 2026
The Parliament proposed bins and locations for the hostels. It asked for bins of 120 litres with pedals, which are larger than the existing ones and would reduce overflowing. It proposed one bin per floor in each block of Parijat Nivas, with one near the entrance to Old Parijat and one near the black gate; two per wing in each block of Palash Nivas, with two per floor in the common area of the main block; two per floor in Bakul Nivas, and one per floor in Kadamba Nivas, with one near the vending machine on the ground floor.

August 2026
The Chair of the Task Force called a review of progress on the decisions of the earlier meeting, before a further meeting of the full Task Force.

In Progress
The Parliament remains on the Task Force. The vending machine being installed in September 2026, recorded in Section 9.5, serves drinks in paper cups rather than plastic.

7.21 Kadamba Mess Pathway

February 2026
The Council met the Registrar, the Dean (Students), and the Engineering Wing on the plan for the pathway from the Kadamba mess to the Vindhya circle. The plan was to close the path, expand the football ground to a standard size, and rebuild the path closer to the new academic block, so that it would also serve as an access path to that building. The work was expected to take three to four months.

In Progress
The work was delayed, and was not complete in September 2026.

7.22 Site for the New Mess

February 2026

The same meeting discussed where to build the new mess. Three sites were considered.

1. The tennis and volleyball courts, which would be demolished and rebuilt along the length of the Felicity ground. This was rejected, because it would leave the campus without any tennis or volleyball courts in the meantime.
2. The paved area in front of the Guest House. This was rejected, because the Institute had other plans for the Guest House and stated that the area was too small for the mess.
3. The Felicity stage area was the only remaining option of the three, and the Institute gave an assurance that at least a temporary stage would be built on the ground for the next edition of Felicity.

7.23 Campus Signage

The Council proposed replacing the street signs across campus once the new academic block, SRIC, and the new hostel are complete. This is work for a future council.

8
Mess Affairs

The Mess Council and its sub-councils worked on menus, food tasting and quality control, hygiene, infrastructure, and coordination with the vendors and CDS. At the start of the term the Council assigned each member a mess to supervise, covering menu planning, infrastructure, inspections, and food tasting, with the sub-councils assisting. The year included a long shortage of cooking gas, the end of one catering contract, the selection of a new caterer, and changes to the dining facilities.

The minutes of the joint meeting of the Mess and Stall Councils with the Chair of the Mess Committee and the Head, CFS on November 12, 2025, are published on the Parliament website.

8.1 Access to Mess Contracts and Accounts

In October 2025 the Council asked the Registrar for the signed contracts of all messes. The Council also asked the caterers for a unit rate bill setting out the cost of each item served. The caterers declined, citing commercial confidentiality, and offered a monthly summary of expenses, income, and wastage instead.

In Progress
The caterers had not supplied the monthly summary at the close of the term.

8.2 Registration and Attendance

In October 2025 the Council changed the breakfast registration capacities at the Kadamba mess to 700 vegetarian and 600 non-vegetarian, from 500 and 800, to match past registrations.

8.3 Mess Timings

In October 2025 the Council asked that mess doors close ten minutes after the official closing time, that refilling stop at the closing time, and that dining halls be cleared thirty minutes after closing.

8.4 Consumption of Mess Food Outside Mess Premises

Students raised concerns about being stopped from carrying food out of the Kadamba mess in containers. The reason given was that students might not eat the food at once, that it could spoil, and that the caterer would be blamed for any illness that followed. Members asked how the planned grab-and-go breakfast counters would work under the

same reasoning. The Head, CFS explained that under the new mess policy, mess food must be eaten on the mess premises. The policy was not finalised during the term, and the restriction was not applied at the other messes.

November 12, 2025
At the joint meeting with the Head, CFS and the Chair of the Mess Committee, it was agreed that students with medical needs may take food parcels from the mess. The meeting also discussed letting students use their own containers, with their names recorded in a register, and a pre-booking option on the mess portal with a charge for packaging and a QR code for each takeaway. It recorded that takeaways should be for emergencies rather than routine use, that food taken out should be eaten in designated outdoor areas rather than in hostel rooms, and that the proposal would go to the Institute Mess Committee and the Registrar.

8.5 Meal Cancellations

During the cooking gas shortage, students requested meal cancellations beyond March 22, 2026, because the reduced menu did not provide adequate nutrition and students were paying for meals they could not use. On March 25, 2026, a student wrote to the Head, CFS, the Chair of the Mess Committee, and CDS, copying the Students list and the Mess Council, noting that no acknowledgment had been received.

Closed
Temporary cancellations were allowed until March 22, 2026. Unrestricted cancellations were not granted.

8.6 Meal Rate Calculation

On May 16, 2026, the Chair of the Mess Committee shared the meal rate calculations for Monsoon 2026 with the Mess Council, and arranged a session to explain the basis of the calculation. The calculations were shared for the Council's understanding and were not circulated publicly.

8.7 Food Wastage

In January 2026 a student proposed a penalty for food wastage above a threshold in the buffet-style messes, with the proceeds going to food donation or sustainability initiatives, and the Council recorded the proposal. Food wastage at the Kadamba mess was recorded in January 2026 at 30 to 100 kilograms a day. In April 2026 the Yuktahar sub-council resolved to record daily wastage in kilograms to help estimate quantities.

In Progress
No penalty was introduced. Wastage recording continues.

8.8 Mess Portal and Feedback

Students recorded little feedback on the mess portal, which made it difficult to raise quality issues with the caterers using data. The feedback section of the portal was improved during the year, and a feedback feature was planned for the Institute's mobile application. The Council also suggested adding Telugu, Hindi, and English names for dishes on the portal menu.

In August 2026 the Council agreed a standard process for publishing menus. All new menus and changes must be e-mailed, in a spreadsheet template, to the mess portal administrators at least four days in advance, with CDS copied and the dates of application stated. New schedules start on Sundays.

8.9 Dietary Options and Extras

February 4, 2026
New menus for the Kadamba, Palash, and Yuktahar messes were announced to students, taking effect from February 8, 2026. Paid additional items, called extras, resumed at dinner at the Kadamba mess. Extras were not introduced at lunch.

February 11, 2026
A mild-spice, low-oil option was introduced at the Kadamba mess, with separate counters for vegetarian and non-vegetarian meals, available on registration. Uptake was very low. Registrations in the first days were in single figures, and the counters were found empty on inspection. The caterer later stated that it could not prepare mild-spice food separately for fewer than 50 registrations.

March 17, 2026
Extras at the Kadamba mess were suspended during the cooking gas shortage recorded in Section 8.10, with approval from the Chair of the Mess Committee and the Head, CFS. Registrations for non-vegetarian extras were moved to vegetarian, and unlimited fruit was provided in compensation.

March 2026
Summer drinks were introduced alongside the reduced menu.

Closed
The mild-spice, low-oil counters were withdrawn, because registrations stayed well below the 50 that the caterer needed to prepare the food separately.

8.10 Cooking Gas Shortage

March 14, 2026
A prolonged shortage of cooking gas cylinders required a much reduced menu. The Palash sub-council met CDS and the mess office to prepare a menu that used less gas. Parathas and pooris were removed, breakfast was reduced to one main item, and lunch and dinner had fewer curry and rice preparations.

March 15, 2026
Cylinders had still not arrived. Plain phulka was served in place of tandoori roti, to save gas for essential preparations.

March 2026
Campus Facilities and Services (CFS) worked to reduce the dependence of the mess kitchens on cooking gas. It arranged new kitchen equipment and moved cooking away from gas and towards electric appliances, including induction stoves, during the shortage.

March and April 2026
Rotis were brought from the Kadamba mess on some days. The Yuktahar sub-council worked through temporary substitutions, reduced gas-intensive items, and kept the Jain alternatives. The reduced menu remained in place until April 30, 2026.

Resolved
The normal menu resumed at the end of April 2026.

8.11 Precautions During the HFMD Outbreak

On August 23, 2026, the Mess Council wrote to CDS requesting precautions in the messes. The request is recorded in Section 5.15.

8.12 Committee on Vegetarian and Non-Vegetarian Cuisine

Office Order 2026/13 of May 15, 2026, constituted a committee to examine issues arising from vegetarian and non-vegetarian food in the campus messes. Its terms of reference asked whether non-vegetarian food should be served in the new mess to be built near the Felicity ground, and whether the Yuktahar mess should be expanded from its current maximum of 400 to 500 places. Two Members of Parliament served on the committee. The committee asked the Parliament to run a survey and to identify students holding a range of views to meet it.

May 28 to June 5, 2026
The Mess Council ran a survey of dining preferences and concerns for the committee. The form required an Institute login, allowed one response per account, and did not collect names or e-mail addresses. It received 1,072 responses.

June 5, 2026
The Mess Council invited students on the Students list to submit their views by June 6, 2026. The call stated that respondents would be selected to represent different opinions, with each batch represented equally.

June 8, 2026
Twelve students were invited to meet the committee. The group covered all undergraduate years, the lateral entry programme, the postgraduate programmes, and the doctoral programme, and was balanced by gender and batch. Ten of them attended.

June 14 to 23, 2026

The Yuktahar sub-council gave the committee its written position, recorded in Section 8.16.8.

The committee's report recommended the following.

1. Four messes on campus, namely Kadamba, Yuktahar, the renovated Palash mess, and the new mess near the Felicity ground.
2. The new mess serves vegetarian and non-vegetarian menus, for about 1,500 people.
3. The renovated Palash mess stays vegetarian, for about 1,000 people.
4. The Kadamba mess stays mixed, for 1,300 to 1,500 people.
5. The Yuktahar mess stays unchanged, with a maximum of 400 people, since a larger mess would dilute its approach.

The committee also recommended that all messes follow the regulations of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India. It recommended that any dishwashers be installed alongside a place where students can rinse their own vessels, so that students continue to take part in running the messes.

In Progress

The Institute had not formally communicated whether it accepted the recommendations when this report was compiled. The arrangements made so far follow the recommended plan. The Palash mess serves only vegetarian food, and the new mess under construction near the Felicity ground is to serve vegetarian and non-vegetarian food.

8.13 Kadamba Mess

8.13.1 Menu

Routine adjustments were made through the year. Ragi idli was replaced with wada to reduce repetition. The breakfast cereal rotation was changed to alternate between four options after a student vote. Paneer sabzi on Sundays was replaced with paneer biryani, following student preference. The schedule was changed so that two heavy items are not served on the same day. The Council compiled student feedback on evening snacks, which identified four highly rated items and four rated below average.

November 6, 2025

A four-week rotating menu was prepared and sent for approval by the nutritionist. The approval did not arrive, which delayed the menu. The Head, CFS eventually confirmed to the mess office that the menu could be implemented without the nutritionist's approval, and suggested adding dishes from other southern states. The new menu was to begin in the first week of the Spring 2026 semester.

December 1, 2025

A feedback form was circulated for the paid additional items.

Mid-August 2026

After masala dosa was discontinued, the Council researched and proposed South Indian specialty dishes to add variety to the menu.

8.13.2 Non-Vegetarian Portion Sizes

November 21, 2025
A student wrote to the mess office and the Head, CFS about inconsistent non-vegetarian portions. The approved policy set the standard serving at 120 to 160 grams. The student borrowed a weighing scale from staff and weighed three servings, all below the lower limit, at 90, 90, and 110 grams.

November 22, 2025
The Head, CFS replied that Prism had been directed to serve four pieces of chicken from November 24, 2025.

December 15, 2025
The mess office announced standard portions on the Students and Research lists. Chicken curry, served at dinner on Mondays and Fridays, has at least 4 pieces of curry-cut chicken regardless of size, with a minimum net weight of 120 grams. Chicken biryani, served at lunch on Wednesdays and Sundays, has at least 3 pieces of biryani-cut chicken per plate, with a net weight of 120 to 150 grams.

January 3, 2026
The Head, CFS confirmed that Prism had been fined Rs. 10,000 for the portion size irregularities.

April 2026
Portion sizes were raised again, along with other concerns at the Kadamba mess.

In Progress
The standard is published, and compliance needs continued monitoring.

8.13.3 Non-Vegetarian Item Found in a Vegetarian Dish

December 13, 2025
A student reported a piece of chicken found in a vegetarian dish to the mess staff and the manager on duty, and e-mailed a photograph of it to the mess office.

December 15, 2025
The Head, CFS replied that Prism had asked for two more days to investigate the cause and report to the Institute.

Resolved
On January 3, 2026, the Head, CFS confirmed that Prism had been fined Rs. 10,000.

8.13.4 Fines

January 3, 2026
The Head, CFS informed the Council that Prism had been fined Rs. 30,000 in total. Rs. 10,000 was for the chicken portions, Rs. 10,000 for the chicken found in a vegetarian dish, and Rs. 10,000 for a third matter. The Council asked about the third fine, and the Head, CFS declined to give details.

8.13.5 Quality and Hygiene

Late December 2025
The high roof was cleaned. Mess staff were asked to clean the spoon and plate racks above the wash basins regularly.

Mid-April 2026
The sub-council escalated the large number of flies landing on food in the dining area.

During 2026 the sub-council also tracked and reported heavily diluted milk, hard sprouts, watery fruit salad, and too little paneer in biryani, and reviewed a complaint about a tamarind seed found in a meal.

8.13.6 Food Tasting

In late April 2026 the sub-council introduced a structured food tasting system. Members were assigned random slots, according to their availability, to evaluate and rate dishes either 30 minutes before a meal or during meal times. Members record feedback in a standard spreadsheet that requires an Institute login.

The Council recorded that tasting checks taste and flavour before service, but does not identify substandard ingredients, which must be reported by e-mail for a penalty to follow.

8.14 Palash Mess and Bakul Mess

October 31, 2025
An idli maker was bought for the Palash mess.

November 14 and 21, 2025
The sub-council held weekly meetings on general issues.

November 15, 2025
A revised menu was introduced after the nutritionist approved it. Kachori, vada pav, and aloo bonda were replaced. Several varieties of phulka were added across meals. Laccha paratha was removed from dinner, and bread pakoda and macaroni were removed.

January 5, 2026
The semester gala dinner took place. The sub-council prepared and finalised the menu with the Mess Council and the vendor, with an emphasis on dishes unlike those on the regular weekly menu.

January 9, 2026
At a meeting with the vendor, the sub-council raised concerns about the similar taste of the paneer dishes, fruit quality, flavoured phulka, and the cabbage preparation. It also raised pending infrastructure items, namely the roti maker, queue management, warm water at the plate-washing area, and inadequate exhaust and ventilation.

January 15, 2026
The Sankranti festive meal took place, after the sub-council prepared the menu and negotiated it with the vendor.

January 20 to February 24, 2026
Repeated failures of the tandoor required substitutes for tandoori roti. Methi-ajwain puri and plain phulka were served on January 20, and plain paratha and phulka on February 8 after a further breakdown. Feedback on food quality during this period included hard puris, excess oil, and inconsistent breakfast and curry preparations.

January 2026
The Mess Council recorded that the Palash mess did not put out glasses when a drink was served, and left out menu items without notice. Both issues were raised with the caterer.

April 17, 2026
The semester gala dinner took place despite the continuing gas constraints. The sub-council prepared the menu through discussion and a student vote on April 13 and 14. It met the vendor on April 16 to plan service and crowd management for 518 registered students.

April 22 to 30, 2026
The sub-council strengthened food tasting through assigned tasting slots and a spreadsheet for feedback. Members rated individual dishes and recorded last-minute changes. On April 30 members prepared the following week's menu with the mess team and sent it to the mess office.

May 31, 2026
The previous catering contract ended. The Palash mess did not operate during June and July 2026.

May 2026
The menu returned to a wider range of preparations. The sub-council continued to prepare weekly rotations and to follow up differences between the approved menu and the mess portal, including an incorrect weekly rotation found on May 16.

June 7, 2026
Five companies submitted bids for the Palash catering contract, two of which had no kitchen in the city.

June 11, 2026
Sub-council members joined the CDS team for an inspection of a prospective vendor's kitchen and a food tasting.

June 2026
Construction began on a new mess near the Felicity ground, which is to serve vegetarian and non-vegetarian food. The committee recorded in Section 8.12 was told that the mess would be ready by December 2026 or January 2027.

July 14, 2026
Vijayalakshmi Caterers was selected through the tender process. The sub-council proposed dishes for trial preparation and took part in menu planning.

July 18 to 20, 2026

The sub-council reviewed the menus for the vegetarian and non-vegetarian facilities. Food was to be prepared at the caterer's base kitchen in Hafeezpet and transported to campus, which limited live preparation.

August 1, 2026

Vijayalakshmi Caterers began service. The Palash mess, which serves only vegetarian food, moved from the first floor of Palash Nivas to the renovated former South mess space on the ground floor. The former Bakul warehouse became the Bakul mess, serving non-vegetarian food until the new mess near the Felicity ground opens, as recorded in Section 8.15.

August 1 to 17, 2026

The first weeks of the new arrangement brought repeated concerns about food availability, hygiene, compliance with the menu, and the quality of transported food. On August 1, food ran short and a palm-oil-based fat spread was used instead of butter. There was a hygiene complaint on August 2, further shortages on August 6, 8, and 10, and a further complaint about the prohibited fat spread on August 15. Differences between the menu and the portal were also found. Students affected by the shortage on August 1 were offered a free replacement meal, subject to verification through the mess portal.

August 10 to 12, 2026

A meeting with Vijayalakshmi Caterers and CDS agreed action points on roti quality, food shortages, hygiene, excess oil, paneer quality, presentation, and consistent serving quantities. For non-vegetarian meals at Bakul, standard portions measured with a weighing scale were agreed, at 150 grams of cooked chicken for biryani and 120 grams for chicken curry. The meeting also proposed continuous monitoring of food availability during meal times and stronger hygiene checks.

August 17, 2026

Following the repeated incidents, the Mess Council recommended penalties totalling Rs. 30,000 under the tender provisions. Rs. 15,000 of fines were applied by the CDS Committee, with strict warnings given to the caterer.

August 23, 2026

The sub-council strengthened tasting before meals. Members were assigned to taste food soon after it arrived and to record each dish's taste, texture, colour, smell, and overall quality. Separate tasting was arranged for the vegetarian and non-vegetarian facilities.

In Progress

Construction of the new mess near the Felicity ground continues. Under the current arrangement, roti freshness and availability, the quality of transported food, food shortages, hygiene, and the timely update of approved menus on the mess portal need continued monitoring.

8.15 Conversion of the Bakul Warehouse

The Bakul warehouse, which stored sports equipment, was converted into a temporary dining facility to provide the seating that the new catering arrangement, recorded in Section 8.14, required.

July 16, 2026
The Mess Council was informed of the decision after it had been taken. The Council had suggested using the Guest House and Palash Nivas, which would have seated about 750 students, but a capacity of 1,000 was required.

July 17, 2026
The Council discussed its response and recorded two objections. The first was that the Institute had not consulted the Parliament before finalising the decision, and had issued no written notice of the change. The second was that the need for more dining capacity had been foreseeable a year in advance, and the decision was made at the last moment.

In Progress
The sports equipment displaced by the conversion needed other storage, which the Council raised separately with the Institute.

8.16 Yuktahar

Yuktahar is a mess that serves wholesome, balanced vegetarian food prepared according to a stated dietary philosophy, and is distinct in purpose from the general messes. The Yuktahar sub-council published minutes of its meetings of November 1, November 4, and November 8, 2025.

8.16.1 Communication

November 25, 2025
The sub-council split its communication with students into two spaces, one for general discussion and feedback and one for official announcements such as menu updates and minutes, so that official information is not lost in long discussions.

8.16.2 Menu Planning

December 6 to 24, 2025
The sub-council planned the winter menu. It considered nutritional variety, seasonal ingredients, variety of grains including millets, protein and micronutrients in a vegetarian diet, the balance between North Indian, South Indian, and regional dishes, the practicality of cooking at scale, taste and acceptance among students, how well dishes go together in a meal, and Jain alternatives. Discussions with faculty and the mess administration led to a preference for a rotating, seasonal menu rather than a single weekly menu. The winter menu was published for use from January 1, 2026.

February to March 2026
The sub-council revised the menu for more variety across a two-week cycle, regional and seasonal dishes, clearer names and allergen information, and updates to the portal.

July and August 2026

The sub-council drafted a menu for the new semester and revised it with feedback from the Ayurvedic practitioner and the vendor, with attention to Jain alternatives and repetition across the two-week cycle. By the end of August, a nearly final menu was before the relevant committee for approval before publication on the portal and registration.

8.16.3 Ayurvedic and Nutritional Review

The sub-council repeatedly requested the formal appointment of an Ayurvedic practitioner, as Yuktahar's governing documents provide.

August 19, 2026

The sub-council held a detailed consultation with the practitioner. It covered the serving of curd and milk, the combination and timing of dairy items, the use of certain seeds with milk, dessert combinations, the rotation of pulses, menu substitutions, the storage and cutting of ingredients such as onion, and whether an electric tandoor is acceptable for rotis. The practitioner confirmed that rotis made in an electric tandoor or by baking are acceptable.

In Progress

The sub-council requested that the principles used to review the menu be documented, so that later councils do not have to reinterpret unclear guidance each year.

8.16.4 Jain Food and Dietary Inclusivity

During the year the sub-council identified meals in which Jain diners lacked an adequate main dish and proposed alternatives. It worked towards at least two Jain-friendly components in each meal, built Jain alternatives into menu planning rather than adding them afterwards, and added variety to the Jain menu.

August 2026

The Chair of the Mess Committee approved an increase in Jain capacity from 10 to 15, which the vendor has since implemented.

Resolved

Students who depend on Jain food have fewer alternatives than other students, so its quantity and availability throughout meal times need particular attention.

8.16.5 Food Quality and Safety

During the year the sub-council raised and followed up items running out before the end of meal times, uneven portions of special items, sour or watery curd, the consistency of sambar and rasam, over-dilution of dishes near the end of service, food that was too bland or too spicy, too little paneer, inconsistent availability of ghee, differences between the published menu and the food served, and late portal updates.

January 8, 2026

Metallic foreign material was found in food. The sub-council took the matter up immediately with the mess team, which checked the vessels, and requested escalation and

follow-up on quality control. Other complaints during the year included stones in food and hygiene concerns about salad ingredients.

January 2026
The Mess Council recorded that the Yuktahar mess did not put out glasses when a drink was served, and raised the issue with the caterer.

August 2026
Follow-up with the vendor again focused on balanced spice, enough food, reliable availability of ghee, and adequate paneer.

8.16.6 Feedback and Tasting

April 22, 2026
The sub-council circulated a form to collect members' availability for structured tasting slots. Members were asked to choose slots by availability rather than by preferred menu items, so that inspections remain representative.

April 2026
Members were asked to record regular feedback in the physical feedback register. The sub-council recorded the need for a single digital feedback system.

8.16.7 Festive, Fasting, and Community Meals

September and October 2025
The sub-council arranged a dedicated fasting menu for Sharadiya Navratri. Members later proposed keeping it as a base for future Navratri periods.

November 5, 2025
Yuktahar hosted the festive meal for Guru Nanak Jayanti.

December 2025
Minor renovation was completed, including replacement of damaged tiles, pest control, deep cleaning, and cleaning of the high roof.

January 8 to 15, 2026
The sub-council planned the Sankranti and Pongal festive menu with the Mess Council and the vendor, representing several regional food traditions within Yuktahar's constraints. The festive lunch was served on January 15, and feedback was recorded.

February 14 and 15, 2026
The sub-council handled a short-notice request for fasting food around Mahashivratri. Options included boiled groundnut, sweet potato, sabudana khichdi, and fruit, and the vendor was consulted on feasibility.

March and April 2026
The sub-council helped with several community meals, including a Kannada and Ugadi meal, a joint Tamil and Malayali new year dinner, and a Marathi community meal. Students organised the meals themselves. The sub-council reviewed the menus, checked that preparation stayed compatible with Yuktahar's constraints and its separate kitchen,

obtained onion and garlic declarations and Jain alternatives, and helped obtain the committee's approval.

April 2026
The sub-council planned quantities for the Marathi community meal from the turnout at an earlier community meal, and underestimated the actual turnout. The sub-council recommended written rules for community meals, covering responsibility for estimating quantities, communication of any price increase, a defined route for approval and communication, and advance registration.

8.16.8 Position on Yuktahar's Purpose

June 14 to 23, 2026
During the changes to the Palash mess, the sub-council was asked for its views on a proposal for Yuktahar to run an additional or expanded counter serving spicier or fried food. The sub-council held an urgent meeting and prepared a written position. Its position was that Yuktahar should remain a distinct system of wholesome, balanced vegetarian food rather than another general mess menu. It also recorded the operational risk of running several overlapping food tracks in one space, particularly where subscribers of one counter take food from another, and the need to keep both core Yuktahar food and Jain food available throughout meal times. The committee recorded in Section 8.12 recommended keeping Yuktahar unchanged.

Resolved
The sub-council placed its position on record, so that the student view on preserving Yuktahar's purpose was formally represented.

8.16.9 Documentation

August 23, 2026
The sub-council set a route for menu changes. The final approved menu is e-mailed to the mess portal administrators with CDS copied, states the dates from which it applies, and is sent early enough for students to register. Minutes of meetings are kept in a shared archive under the Yuktahar account.

Resolved
Menu changes now reach the portal before registration opens.

8.16.10 Registration and Awareness

August 8, 2026
A meeting considered the relatively low registration for Yuktahar, and concluded that improving it requires better food, better communication, and better understanding of what Yuktahar offers, rather than publicity alone. The meeting proposed a session for students explaining Yuktahar's ingredients and approach to preparation, use of the display near Yuktahar for ingredient and food information, a short information document for students, a sink near the preparation area so that vegetables need not be carried elsewhere to be washed, and an electric tandoor.

In Progress

These items were carried forward to the incoming sub-council.

9
Stall Affairs

The Stall Council worked with stall vendors, students, and the administration on food variety, hygiene, service quality, pricing, and the introduction and removal of stalls.

The stalls that operated during the term were the tea stall, JC, BBC, VC, David's Canteen, the Chaat Canteen, Mandrus Kitchen, the coconut stall, and, until April 2026, Tantra, along with two vending machine operators. At the start of the term the Council assigned one member to each stall as its point of contact.

9.1 Kitchen Inspections and Compliance

In October 2025 the Council set food preparation standards for all stalls. Vegetarian and non-vegetarian preparation areas and utensils must be kept separate, and all staff who prepare or serve food must wear gloves. VC already used separate pans for eggs and for vegetarian dishes, and BBC bought an extra pan to do the same. The Council inspected the kitchens of all campus stalls through the year.

November 2025
An inspection found the kitchen of the Tantra Canteen unhygienic and below cleanliness standards. The Council directed the owner to act immediately and inspected again to confirm. The Council also required all food in kitchen storage to be labelled with its expiry date.

August 2026
The Council requested VC to keep snack items covered and protected from flies. It required Mandrus Kitchen to keep separate sections for preparing and serving vegetarian and non-vegetarian food.

September 2026
The plates, serving containers, and other serving materials at David's Canteen were brought in line with the prescribed standards, moving away from single-use plastic.

9.2 Carbonated Drinks

In October 2025 the Council confirmed that, under an Institute rule, stalls may not sell packaged carbonated drinks. A court order restricting the sale of such drinks in educational institutions was cited in support of the rule. Stalls may not sell packaged electrolyte drinks. JC may continue to serve drinks it prepares with soda. Carbonated drinks were to be withdrawn from the BB Instant vending machines.

Resolved
Some stalls continued to sell packaged carbonated drinks, and the Council required them to follow the Institute rule. The stalls stopped selling them once their existing stock ran out.

9.3 Removal of the Tantra Canteen

The Tantra Canteen had moved from the Guest House canteen to the BBC area as a temporary arrangement during mess renovations, and the area around its new location was not well suited to running a kitchen. The Council's inspection in November 2025, recorded in Section 9.1, had found its kitchen unhygienic.

April 2, 2026
During a routine inspection, the Stall Council found a curry in the refrigerator that appeared spoiled, food items that appeared expired or improperly stored, and products whose brands could not be verified. When members returned to verify the curry, staff had already disposed of it. A sample collected earlier was stored in the Kadamba mess kitchen. Early on April 3, the Council reported the findings to the Chair of the Mess Committee, the Head, CFS, and CDS, and requested an investigation.

April 3, 2026
CDS terminated the contract with immediate effect. It cited evidence that stale and contaminated food had been served, and a recurrence of lapses after earlier warnings. It imposed a penalty and barred the removal of equipment until dues were cleared.

April 4, 2026
The vendor disputed the findings and requested a review. CDS replied the same day that its decision was final, and directed the vendor to vacate the premises.

September 2026
Demolition of the Tantra building was approved, and a new stall with better facilities is planned in its place.

In Progress
The Council was looking for a replacement for Tantra at the close of the term, including through a proposal for a food truck near the Guest House, which would need no permanent construction. The Council expects the renovation of David's Canteen, recorded in Section 9.11, and the Prism night canteen, recorded in Section 9.4, to improve the food available at night.

9.4 New Stalls and Trial Runs

October 26, 2025
The Stall Council followed up a proposal for a coconut stall from the previous term. It recommended and ran a trial, collected student feedback, and approved the stall to continue. Early reviews praised its prices and quality.

November 20, 2025
The Council coordinated and supervised the trial run of Mandrus Kitchen, which offered waffles and shawarma. It collected student feedback during the trial on food quality, pricing, and demand, and shared suggestions with the owners. Based on the reviews, the waffles continued and the shawarma was withdrawn.

November 2025
VC proposed adding paneer paratha and aloo paratha to its menu. The Council ran a trial and agreed to the prices.

July 2026
The Council ran a trial of Ching's. Based on student reviews, the stall was not taken forward.

August 2026
The Council agreed to let Prism open a night canteen, to give students more choice at night and to serve proper meals after regular dinner hours.

August and September 2026
Mandrus Kitchen expanded its menu with burgers, wraps, drinks, spring rolls, samosas, and other items.

September 2026
The Council prepared the menu for the night canteen, and revised it on feedback from students, to improve the food available at night.

In Progress
The opening of the night canteen is pending some infrastructure requirements. The Council otherwise focused on managing the existing stalls well, rather than on adding vendors.

9.5 Vending Machines

The Council reviewed the BB Instant vending machines on campus. Each purchase required a wallet top-up of Rs. 100, which inconvenienced students.

December 2025
After evaluating alternatives, the Council identified GoGrab as a provider with better usability and began discussions.

February 2026
A memorandum of understanding with GoGrab was under negotiation.

June 2026
The GoGrab machine was installed. The Council pursued a countersigned copy of the contract, which the vendor returned after several weeks.

July 2026
The Director noted that the machine was using the Institute network. The Council took this up with the vendor, who agreed to install its own wireless connection within four days. The vendor did so, and the Council confirmed this to the Head, CFS and the Chair of the Mess Committee. The Council was also asked to check the BB Instant machine, and found that it was not on the Institute network.

September 2026
A LeanSip machine was being installed to provide electrolyte drinks and protein shakes. The machine prepares drinks on demand and serves them in paper cups, in line with the Institute's work on reducing single-use plastics, recorded in Section 7.20.

September 2026
The Council identified three more locations for GoGrab machines, namely the second floor of the administrative block, the ground floor of the T-Hub building, and the main block of Parijat Nivas. It obtained the permissions for all three, and the vendor installed the machines.

In Progress
The Council is arranging more vending machines from both GoGrab and BB Instant.

9.6 Pricing and Vendor Coordination

In October 2025 the Council confirmed that no vendor may raise prices without its prior formal agreement. At the previous increase, vendors had cited higher rent and water charges. Under a rule set in the previous term, prices are revised annually. The interval had varied by vendor, and longer intervals had produced larger single increases.

June and July 2026
The Council negotiated the annual revisions. The tea stall did not raise its prices for the year, so its next revision will be larger. The Council negotiated the increases proposed by the Chaat Canteen, JC, and Mandrus Kitchen.

The scheduled revision in 2025–2026 was not applied consistently because of the cooking gas shortage, and some prices at BBC and VC were revised outside the normal cycle.

In Progress
The Council kept in regular contact with vendors about their operational concerns, balancing the interests of students against the needs of vendors.

9.7 Stall Timings and Weekly Closures

Stalls did not always keep to their stated hours, and CDS had proposed a weekly day off for each stall, as recorded in Section 9.9.

September 2026
The Council required all stalls to keep strictly to their stated hours. It encouraged each stall to close for one day every week, starting October 1, 2026.

In Progress
The weekly closures take effect from October 1, 2026.

9.8 Regularity of the Coconut Stall

The coconut stall did not open on a regular schedule, so students could not rely on it.

September 2026
The Council raised a complaint asking that the coconut stall open regularly.

Unresolved
The complaint brought no change by the close of the term.

9.9 Vacation Operations

Several stalls closed during the summer vacation, for different reasons.

June 16, 2026
CDS informed the Council of the position of several stalls. David's Canteen and BBC were closed for personal reasons. Mandrus Kitchen reported losses over the vacation and requested permission to stay closed until July 15 for renovation.

The Council objected to the closure of Mandrus Kitchen, noting that June is the peak period for interns and summer school participants, who do not have mess registration, and asked that the stall open by July 1. The Council also proposed that the Institute reduce rent during vacations if the difficulty is financial.

In Progress
The stalls reopened when the semester began, except BBC, which reopened at a new site on September 13, 2026, as recorded in Section 9.10. The wider question of planning for closures during vacations remains under discussion. CDS proposed a weekly rotation giving each stall a periodic day off for deep cleaning and maintenance, a vacation plan, and a way to maintain service when a vendor closes for personal reasons.

9.10 Relocation of BBC

BBC, the Basketball Canteen, closed during the summer vacation while its owner took a break, as recorded in Section 9.9. After the owner returned, the canteen stayed closed for a while as it moved to a new site near David's Canteen.

September 13, 2026
The canteen reopened at its new site under its official name, BSB, short for Bolledupati Sitaram and Brothers, with better infrastructure and an expanded menu. Because of its new location, students also call it the Besides Banyan Canteen.

September 2026
The Council finalised a menu with BSB and negotiated its prices. It designed a new menu card, which BSB displays at the stall.

9.11 Renovation of David's Canteen

September 2026
David's Canteen began a renovation and expansion. The Council supervised the work and coordinated it with CDS.

In Progress
The renovation was ongoing at the close of the term.

9.12 Stalls at the Recreation Centre

The CDS Committee proposed that the stalls in SRIC be selected by tender, and that the existing stalls stay where they are. No final decision has been taken. The kitchen space in SRIC has only one common area for washing plates and utensils, which makes it easier for a single caterer to run all the stalls, while the Stall Council would prefer a variety of stalls.

In Progress

9.13 Seating and Shelter

November 2025
The Council requested new tables for all canteens, and rain shelters, noting that the existing shelters do not cover the tables adequately.

Resolved
The Institute stated that seating is the responsibility of the stall owners. Some tables and chairs from the closed South mess were moved near JC and the tea stall, following requests for more seating there.

10
Conclusion

The Parliament thanks the students of the Institute, who raised issues with their representatives, took part in its surveys and consultations, and followed its work throughout the term. We thank the faculty and staff members of the Institute for their continuous help and support.

The Parliament thanks the Election Commission and the previous Parliaments, whose work this term built on.

The Speaker thanks the Council Secretaries for their inputs to this report, the General Secretary for signing it off, and all Members of Parliament for their work over the term.

Any inaccuracies or omissions in this report are unintentional. To report an error, share feedback, or request information, e-mail the Parliament at parliament@students.iiit.ac.in.

Compiled by
Vedant Kulkarni
Speaker
Students' Parliament 2025–2026

Signed off by
Sanyam Gandhi
General Secretary
Students' Parliament 2025–2026

Appendix

A Abbreviations

The following abbreviations are used in this report.

2AC, 3AC	Second and third class air-conditioned coaches on Indian Railways.
4G, 5G	The fourth and fifth generations of mobile network technology.
BBC	Basketball Canteen, now also called the Besides Banyan Canteen after its move near David's Canteen.
BSB	Bolledupati Sitaram and Brothers, the official name of BBC at its new site.
BWC	Building Works Committee, which oversees building works on campus.
CAO	Chief Administrative Officer of the Institute.
CCTV	Closed-circuit television, the security camera system on campus.
CDS	Campus Dining Services, which manages the messes, stalls, and their contracts.
CFS	Campus Facilities and Services, which manages hostels and campus infrastructure.
CHMC	Campus Health and Medical Committee, responsible for Aarogya and student health.
CISO	Chief Information Security Officer of the Institute.
COW	Council of Wardens, the committee responsible for hostel administration.
DC	Disciplinary Committee, which hears cases of student misconduct.
EPTRI	Environment Protection Training and Research Institute, an external testing laboratory.
GSC	Gender Sensitisation Committee, which works on awareness of gender issues.
HFMD	Hand, Foot, and Mouth disease, a contagious viral illness.
IAC	Institute Affairs Committee, which decides Institute-wide policy.
IMS	Institute Management System, the portal for attendance, leave, grades, and transcripts.
IT	Information technology, as in the IT Office, which runs the campus network.
JC	Juice Canteen.
LAN	Local area network, the wired network in the hostels.
MoU	Memorandum of understanding, a written agreement such as the one with Care Hospital.
MS, PhD	Master of Science and Doctor of Philosophy, the research degree programmes.
PG Cell	Postgraduate Cell, which handles postgraduate and research programmes.
RO	Reverse osmosis, a method of water filtration used in the hostel water coolers.
SAC	Student Affairs Committee, the Institute committee for student matters.
SAVE	Sports, Arts, and Value Education, the compulsory Pass/Fail courses.
SGPA	Semester Grade Point Average, the average of a student's grades in one semester.
SLO	Student Life Office, which handles student activities and student bodies.
SRIC	Student Recreation and Introspective Centre, the new building that will house a cafeteria, a music room, two gymnasiums, meeting rooms, and indoor sports facilities, among other things.
TDS	Total dissolved solids, the mineral content of water in parts per million.
TRC	Technical Resource Committee, which decides on software and subscriptions.
VC	Vindhya Canteen.
WMC	Water Monitoring Committee, responsible for water supply and testing.

B Members of Parliament

The following are the Members of the Students' Parliament for the 2025–2026 term, with the office each of them held. Members who resigned or were removed during the term are marked. Some members graduated at the convocation in July 2026 and remained members for the rest of the term. The members of each council were sent to students by e-mail at the start of the term.

Officers

Vedant Rahul Kulkarni	Speaker
Sanyam Gandhi	General Secretary
Anshul Krishnadas Bhagwat	Academic Secretary
Pradeep Anagha	Research Secretary
Neharika Rajesh	Health Secretary
Balalikhith Kanigolla	Joint Hostel Secretary
Veena Ramadas	Joint Hostel Secretary
Pratyush Vempati	Infrastructure Secretary
Naveen Gajingam	Mess Secretary
Sukasi Manidhar	Kadamba Mess Secretary
Vadla Shiva Kishan	Palash Mess Secretary
Aaryan Kashyap	Stall Secretary

Members

Advait Vuppalanchi	Member
Alapati Sai Pavan Adit	Member
Arghya Roy	Member
Chaitanya Thogata	Member
Chanda Akshay Kumar	Member
Chandrahas Nandibhatla	Member
Damini Chandi Priya Adusumilli	Member
Daniel Vincent	Member
Hemang Joshi	Member
Hershi Jaiswal	Member
Hritik Ranjan	Member
Kattagani Haasini	Member
Kimaya Arora	Member
Nallasingu Jagankrishna	Member
Prakhar Jain	Member
Shree Mitra	Member
Shubham Gupta	Member
Sunil Kumar	Member
Surtani Monica	Member
Vaishnav Soham	Member
Vrishin Manan Shah	Member

Advisor

Pradeep Pal	Advisor

Resigned/Removed

Devansh Kantesaria	Removed
Gaurav Goswami	Removed
Vinay Lanke	Removed
Yaswanth Gangineni	Resigned